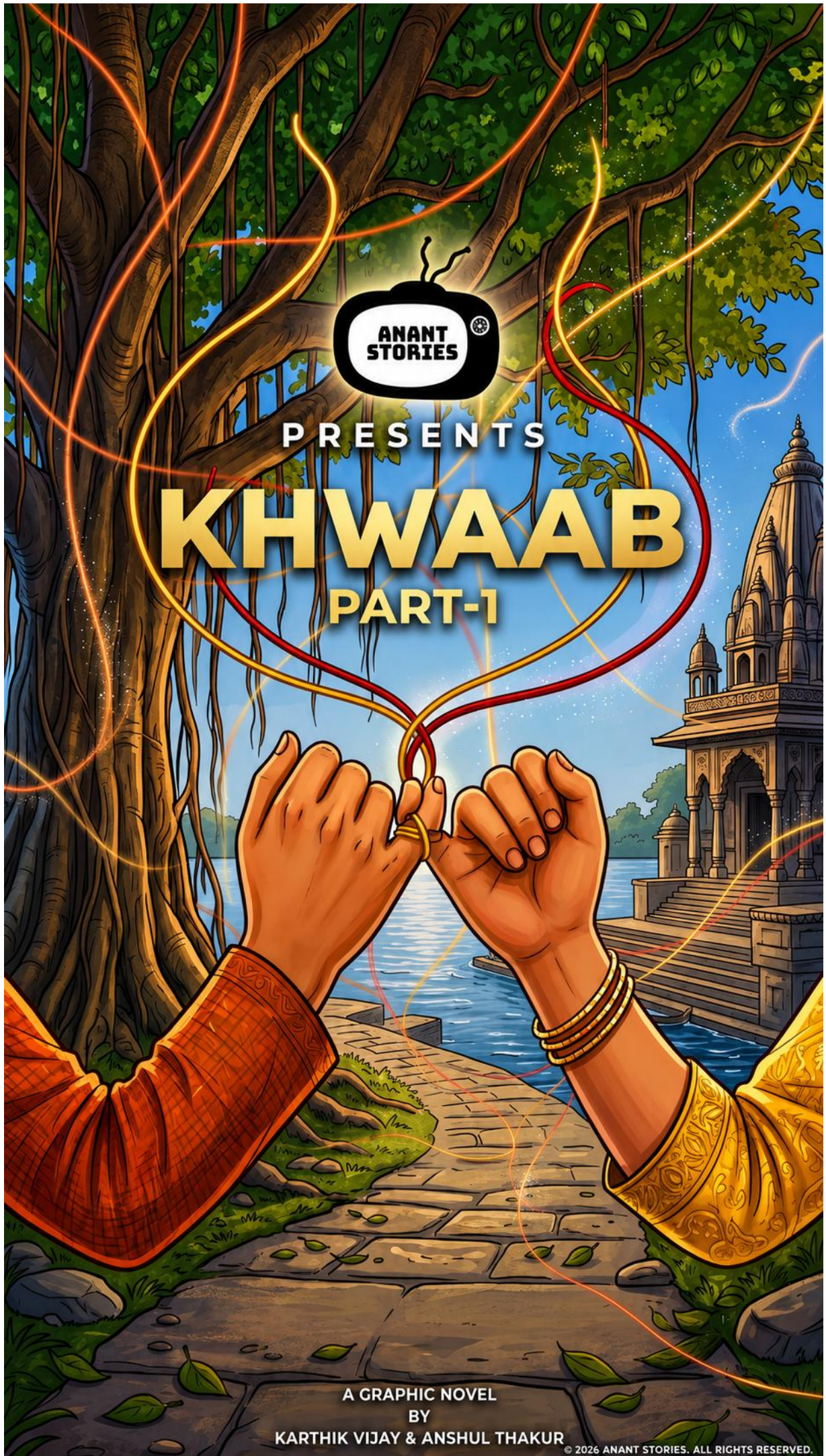




PRESENTS

KHWAAB

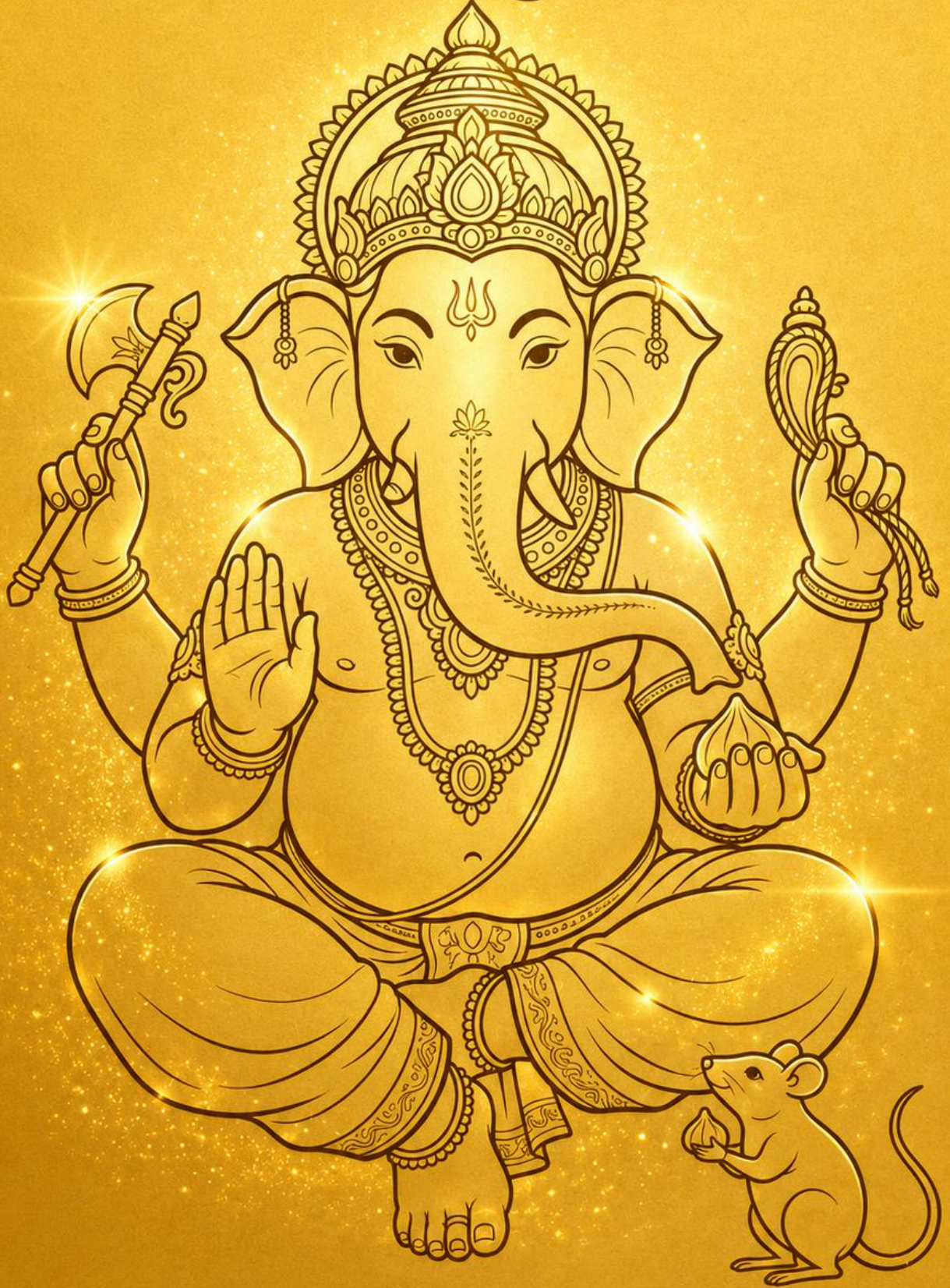
PART-1



A GRAPHIC NOVEL
BY
KARTHIK VIJAY & ANSHUL THAKUR

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॥ श्री गणेशाय नमः ॥



वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय सूर्यकोटि समप्रभ।
निर्विघ्नं कुरु मे देव सर्वकार्येषु सर्वदा॥



SPECIAL THANKS

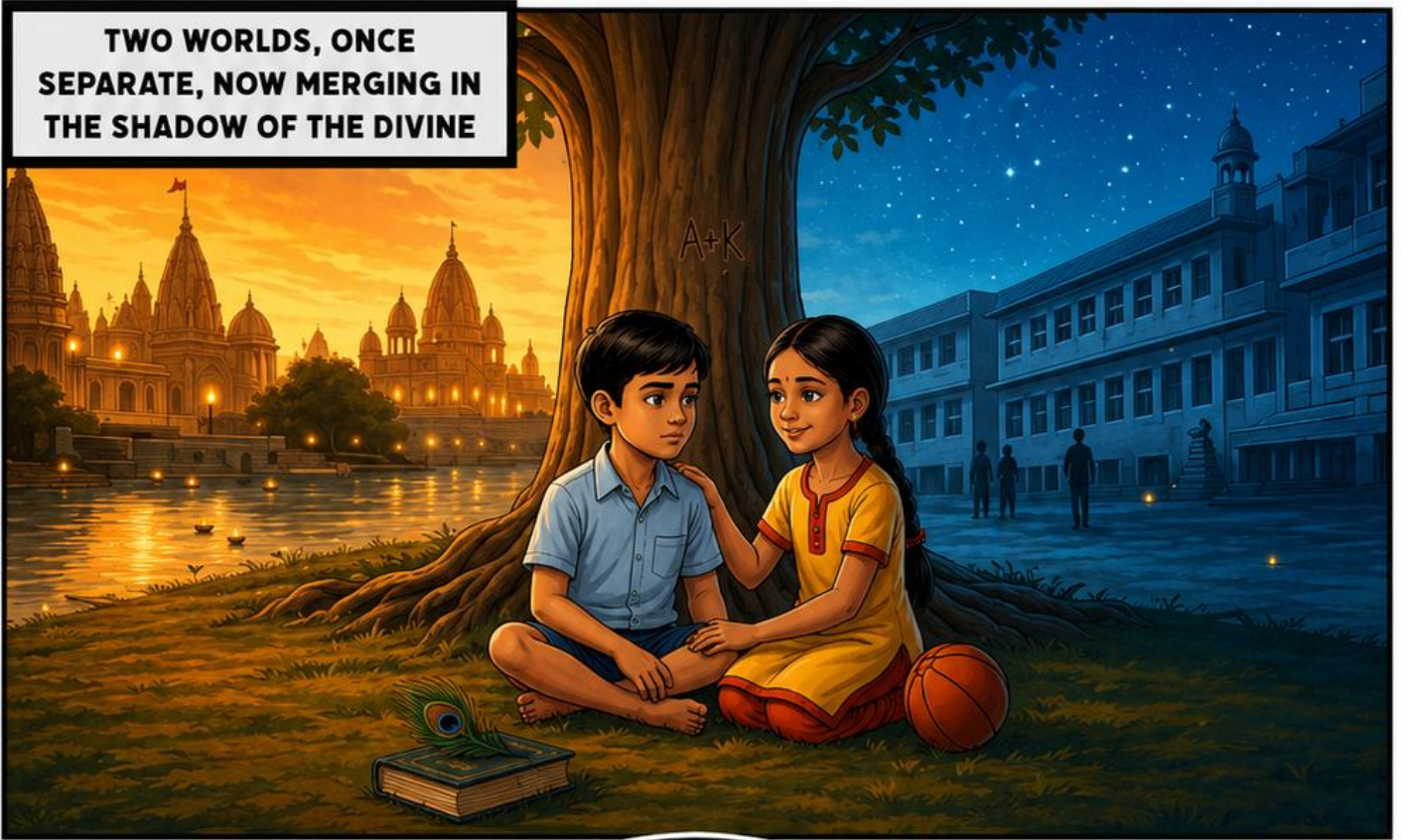
This graphic novel is woven from the love, faith, and relentless encouragement of those who stood by me through the darkest times. My deepest gratitude goes to **MY BIG BROTHER**, whose constant push and unshakeable belief forced me to step out of my comfort zone and bring this vision to life. Most importantly, I bow before my ultimate mentor, **LORD SHREE KRISHNA**. Thank you, Kanha Ji, for being my strength, my confidence, and for granting me a disciplined mind to rebuild and create, even after the greatest downfall. Today, I am truly proud to call myself a Graphic Novel Creator.

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Production Methodology: All panels within this graphic novel feature AI-generated visual elements; however, the underlying structural designs, compositions, and logic were meticulously handcrafted through simulations. These original frameworks were systematically blended using advanced AI models to achieve the final cohesive comic narrative.

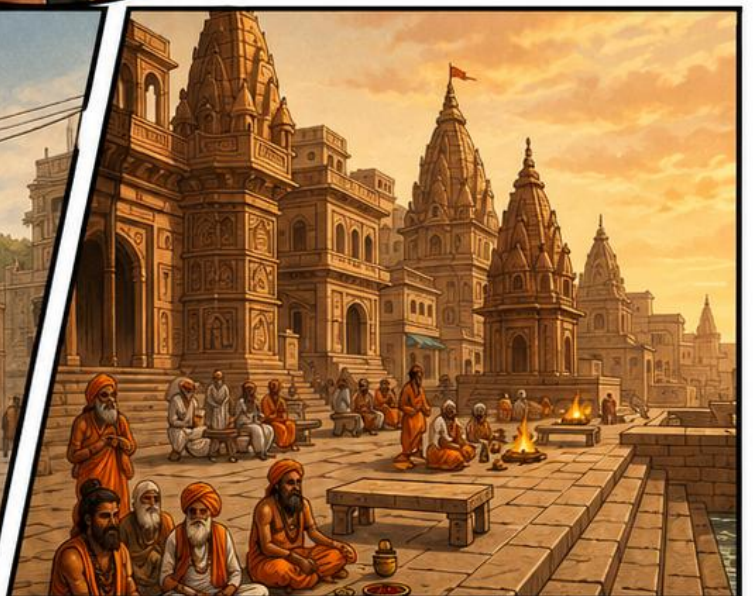
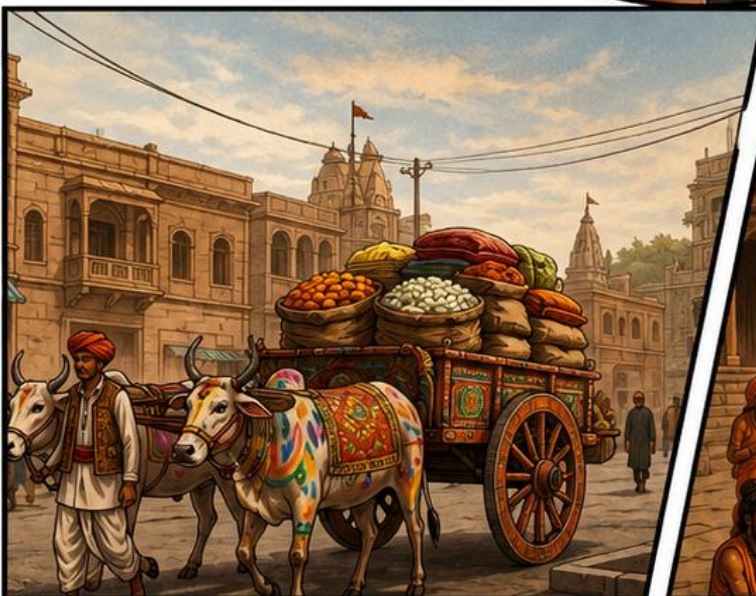
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**TWO WORLDS, ONCE
SEPARATE, NOW MERGING IN
THE SHADOW OF THE DIVINE**



**AVNISH — BORN
IN MATHURA,
THE SACRED
CITY OF LORD
KRISHNA**

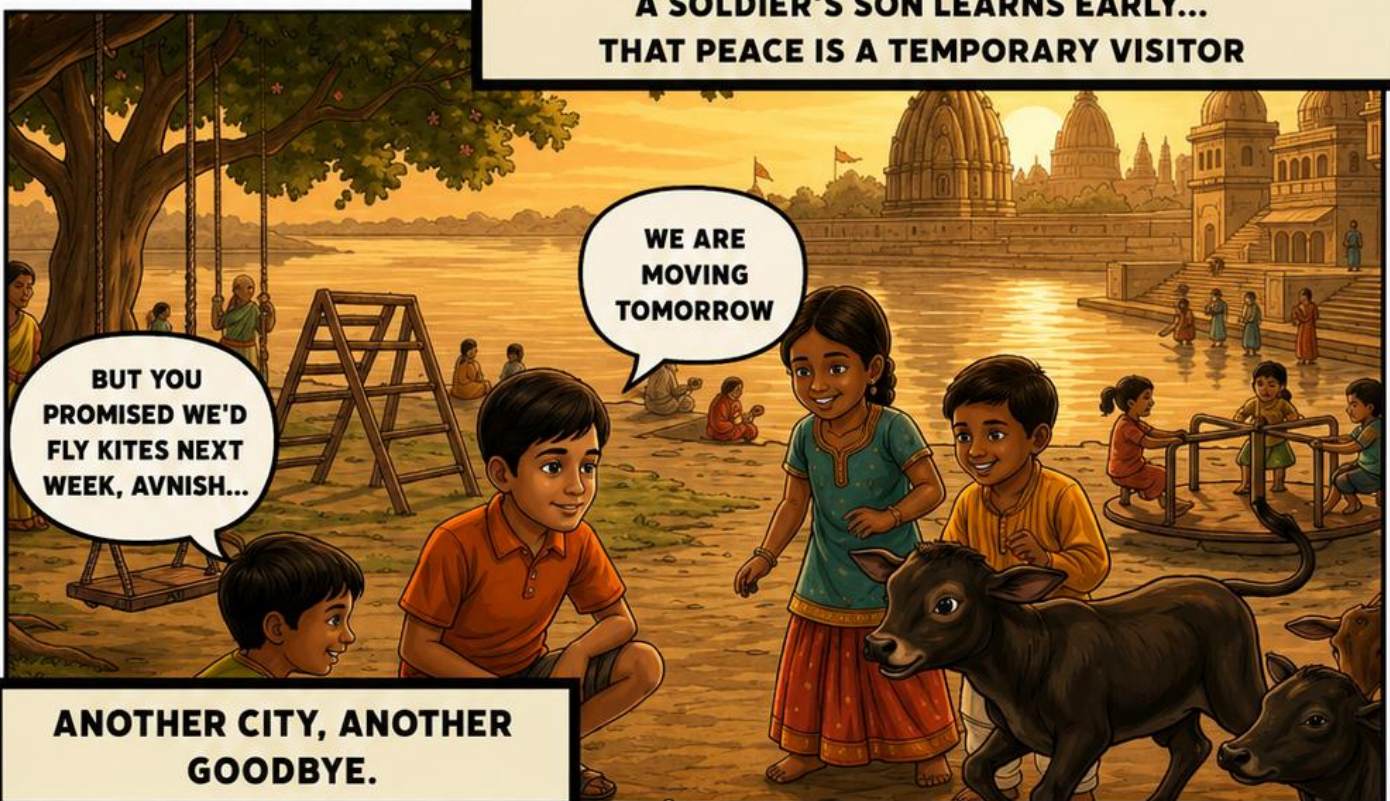
**KANISHKA —
BORN IN KASHI,
THE ANCIENT
CITY OF LORD
SHIVA**



AVNISH'S JOURNEY BEGAN IN THE HOLY CITY OF MATHURA, WHERE DISCIPLINE MET DEVOTION



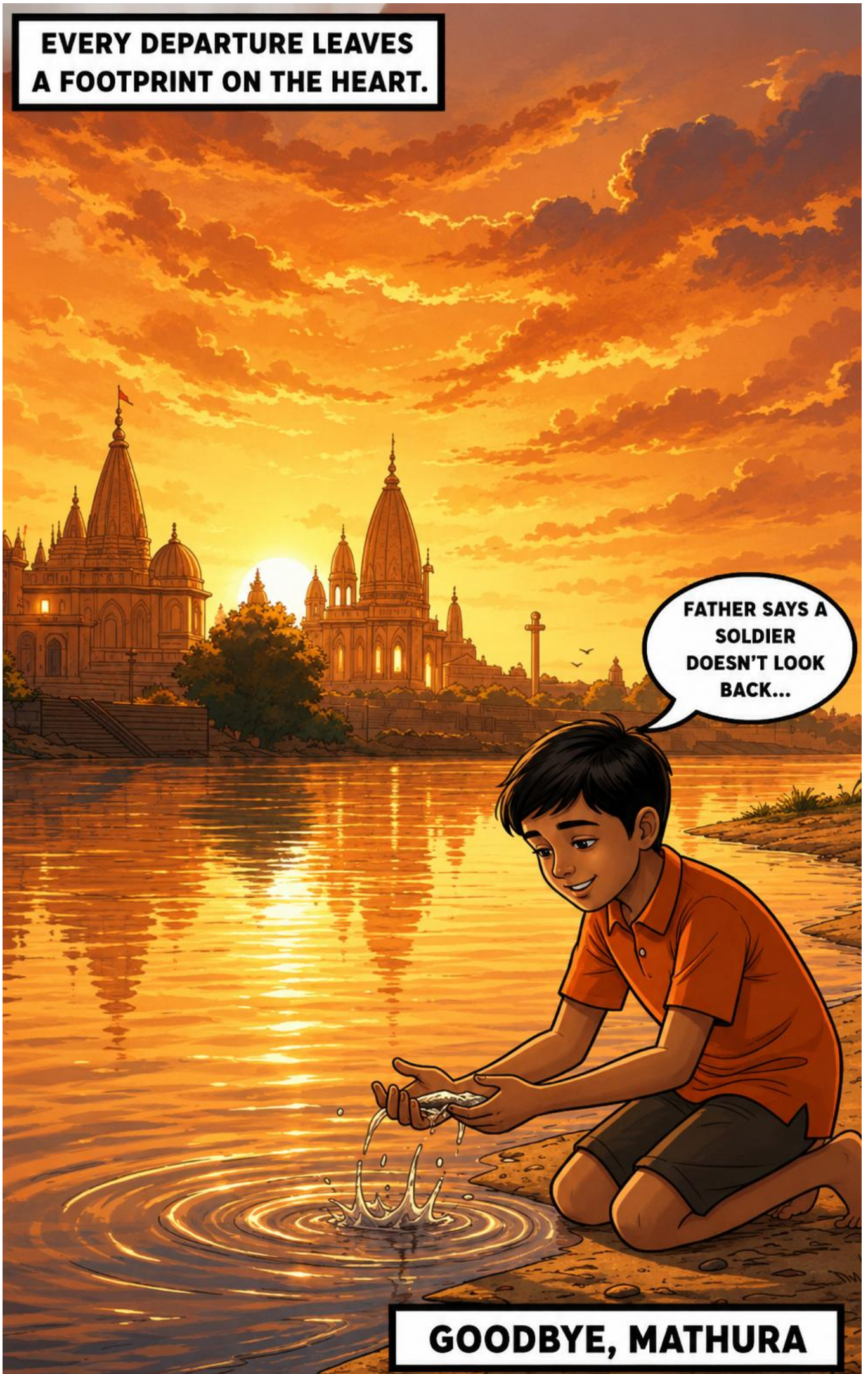
**A SOLDIER'S SON LEARNS EARLY...
THAT PEACE IS A TEMPORARY VISITOR**



**EVERY DEPARTURE LEAVES
A FOOTPRINT ON THE HEART.**

**FATHER SAYS A
SOLDIER
DOESN'T LOOK
BACK...**

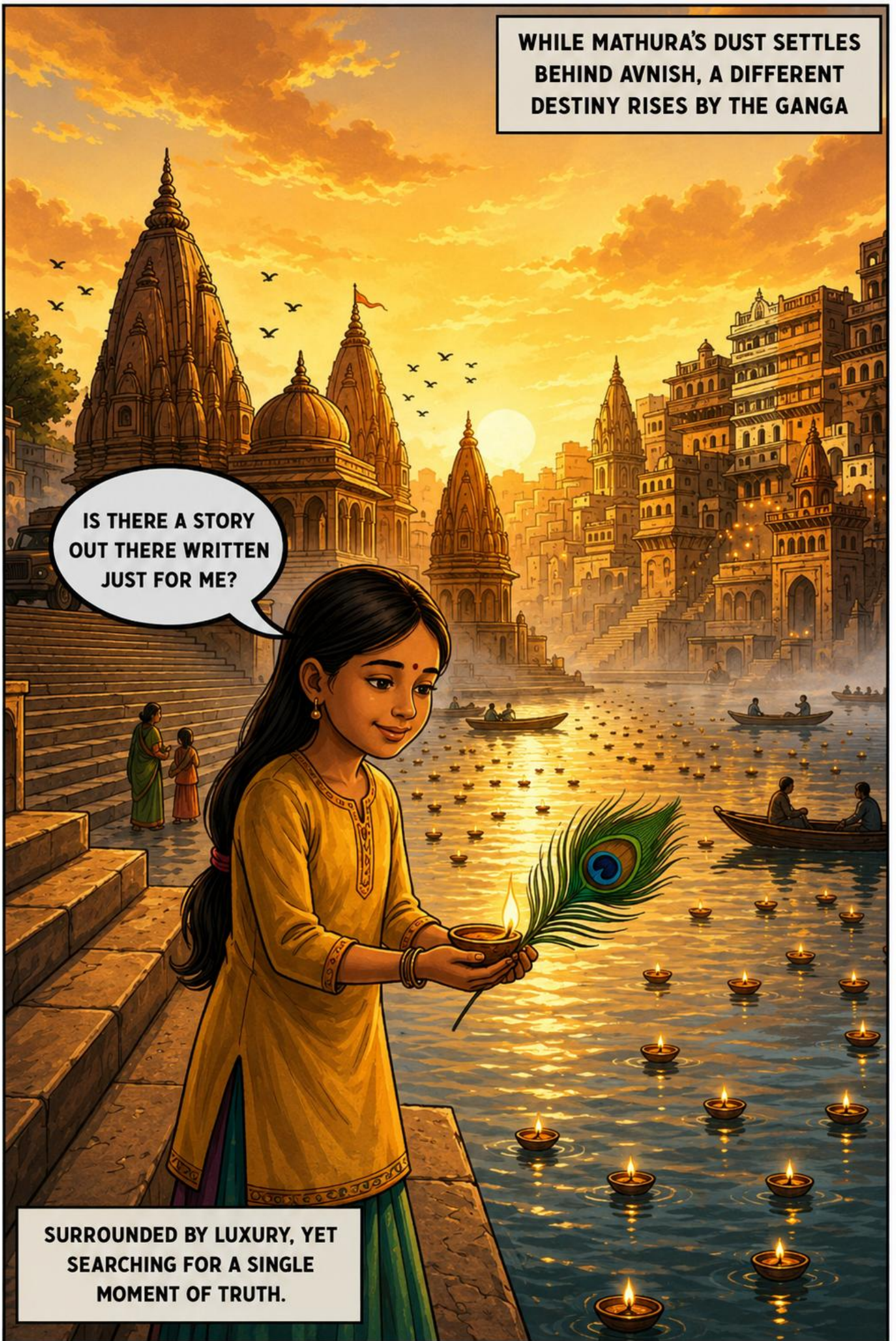
GOODBYE, MATHURA



**WHILE MATHURA'S DUST SETTLES
BEHIND AVNISH, A DIFFERENT
DESTINY RISES BY THE GANGA**

**IS THERE A STORY
OUT THERE WRITTEN
JUST FOR ME?**

**SURROUNDED BY LUXURY, YET
SEARCHING FOR A SINGLE
MOMENT OF TRUTH.**





ANOTHER CITY,
ANOTHER BIG
HOUSE. BUT DOES
IT EVER FEEL LIKE
HOME?

...THE DEAL HAS TO
CLOSE BY
TOMORROW. I DON'T
CARE ABOUT THE
COSTS!



IS THERE A
STORY OUT
THERE WRITTEN
JUST FOR ME?

KANISHKA WAS THE DAUGHTER OF IMMENSE
WEALTH, BUT SHE OFTEN FELT LIKE A STRANGER IN
HER OWN LIFE.



EXCELLENT.
PREPARE THE NEW
ITINERARY
IMMEDIATELY.

WE TRAVEL THE
WORLD, BUT WE
NEVER STAY LONG
ENOUGH TO GROW
ROOTS

FOR KANISHKA, LIFE WAS A
GOLDEN CAGE



**VRINDAVAN—WHERE
EVERY CORNER
WHISPERS A STORY OF
KRISHNA.**

**HURRY, WE'LL
MISS THE
EVENING AARTI!**

**RADHE RADHE!
SIDE PLEASE!**



**RADHE
RADHE!!!**



**A CHAOTIC SYMPHONY OF
BELLS, SHOUTS, AND PRAYERS.**

**IN THE HEART OF BANKE BIHARI, TIME DOESN'T
MOVE IN MINUTES IT MOVES IN HEARTBEATS**



**RADHE
RADHE!**

**JAI SHREE
KRISHNA!**

**LOOK! HIT THE
CENTER!**

**SHHH! PLAY
QUIET, THE
AARTI IS
STARTING.**

**VRINDAVAN—AN EMOTION THAT STAYS,
LONG AFTER THE BELLS STOP RINGING**



LET'S GET THE BAGS INSIDE. IT'S BEEN A LONG JOURNEY

AVNISH, TAKE THE SMALLER BAG. DON'T STAND THERE DAYDREAMING



COMING, MAA. I WAS JUST... LOOKING AT THE LIGHTS

THIS AIR FEELS DIFFERENT, MAA... LIKE A MEMORY I HAVEN'T LIVED YET

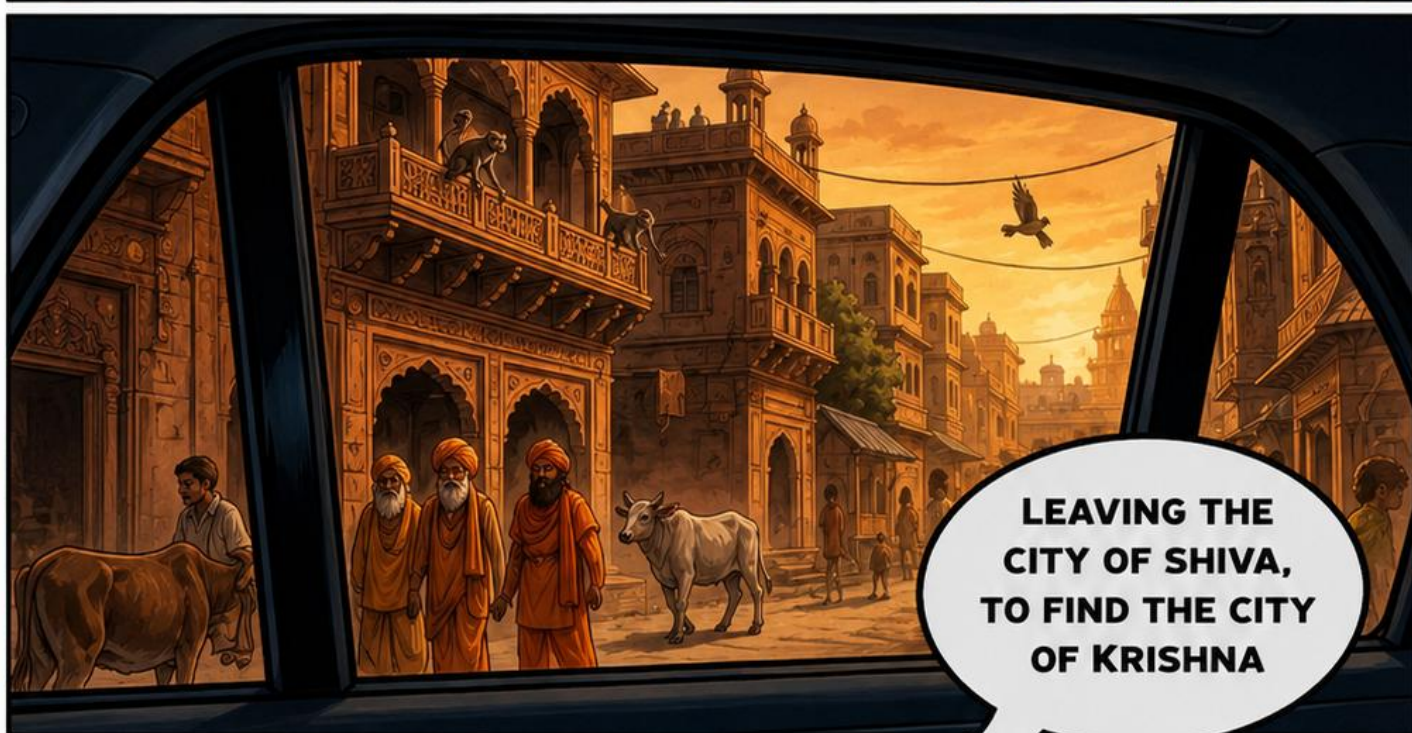


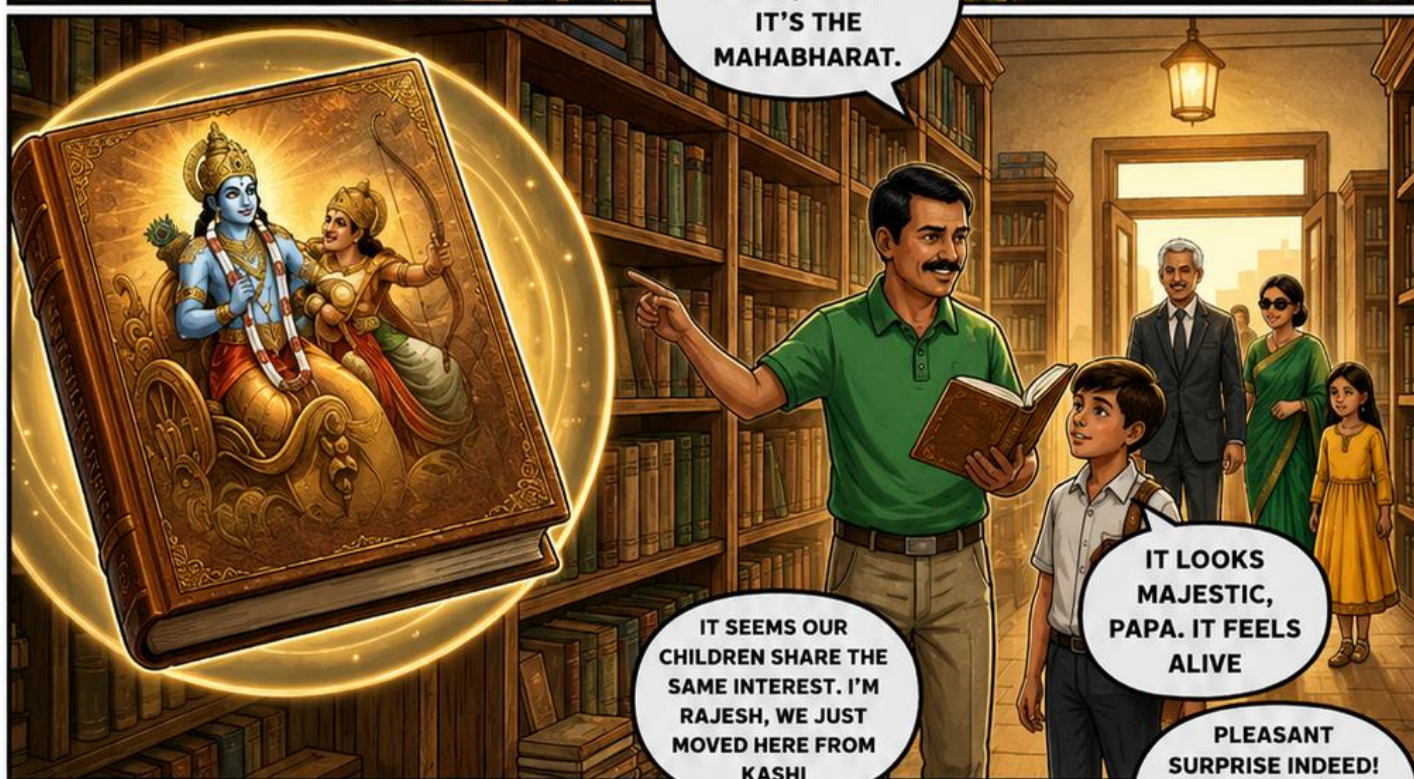
SOMEWHERE IN THAT GOLDEN MAZE, ANOTHER STORY WAITS

**VRINDAVAN—WHERE THE
EARTHLY AND THE DIVINE
BEGIN TO BLUR**



**TWO LIVES ENTER THIS
SACRED CIRCLE, UNAWARE
THEIR STORY WAS
WRITTEN CENTURIES AGO**





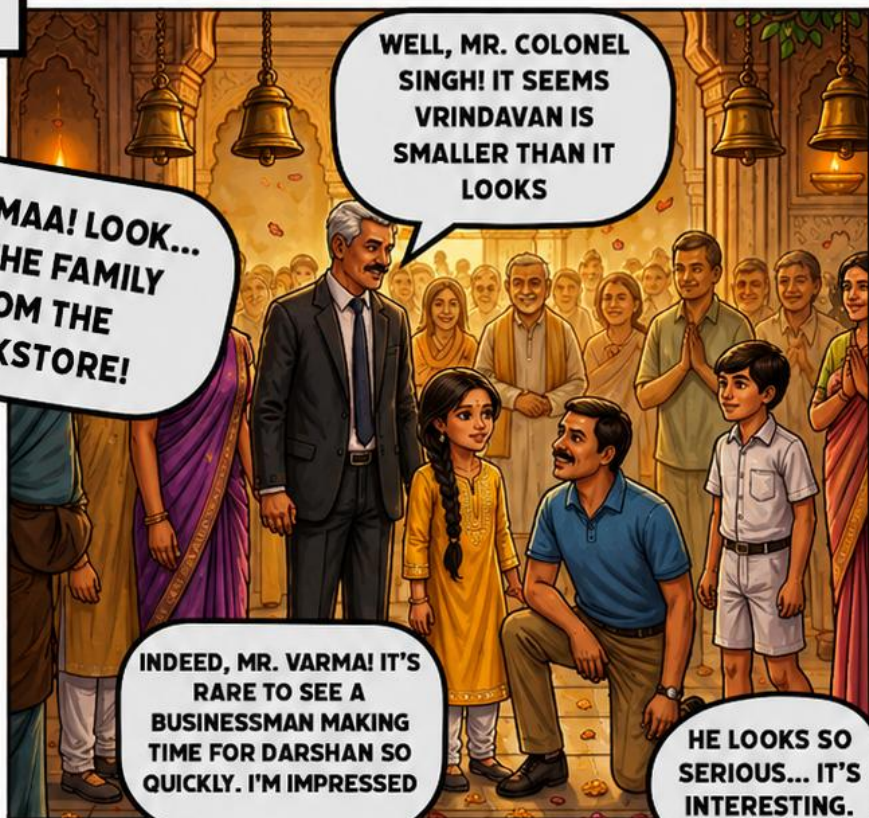


THE ENERGY
HERE IS
INCREDIBLE, IT
FEELS ALIVE.

VRINDAVAN... WHERE EVERY
CORNER WHISPERS A STORY OF
DEVOTION.



PAPA! MAA! LOOK...
IT'S THE FAMILY
FROM THE
BOOKSTORE!



WELL, MR. COLONEL
SINGH! IT SEEMS
VRINDAVAN IS
SMALLER THAN IT
LOOKS

INDEED, MR. VARMA! IT'S
RARE TO SEE A
BUSINESSMAN MAKING
TIME FOR DARSHAN SO
QUICKLY. I'M IMPRESSED

HE LOOKS SO
SERIOUS... IT'S
INTERESTING.



FATE, IT SEEMS, HAS A WAY OF GUIDING
GOOD PEOPLE BACK TO THE SAME CIRCLE.



SHE LOOKS
DIFFERENT OUTSIDE
THE BOOKSTORE...
KIND OF CUTE

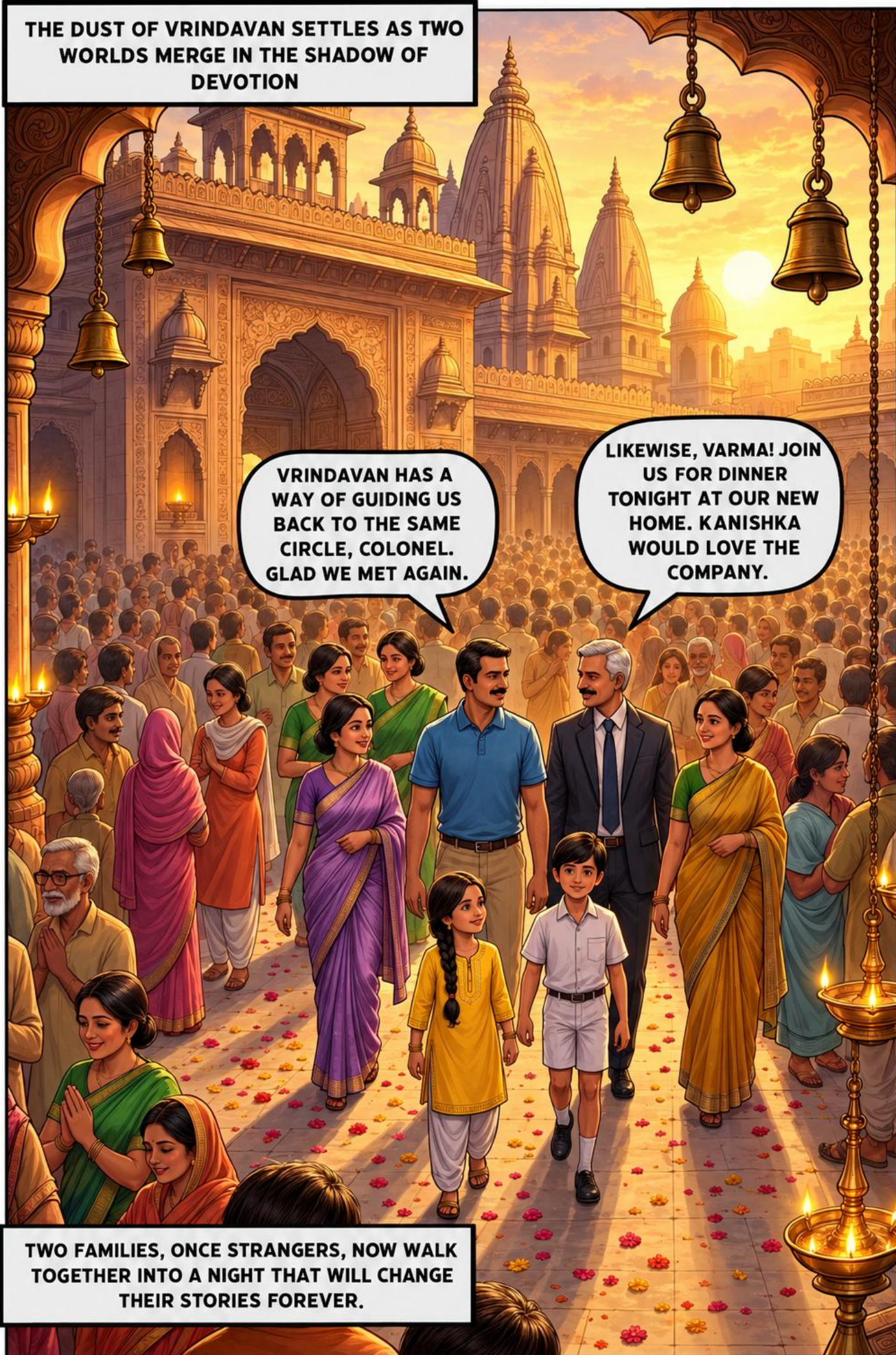
TWO STRANGERS, A SINGLE DESTINATION,
AND A STORY WAITING TO UNFOLD

**THE DUST OF VRINDAVAN SETTLES AS TWO
WORLDS MERGE IN THE SHADOW OF
DEVOTION**

**VRINDAVAN HAS A
WAY OF GUIDING US
BACK TO THE SAME
CIRCLE, COLONEL.
GLAD WE MET AGAIN.**

**LIKEWISE, VARMA! JOIN
US FOR DINNER
TONIGHT AT OUR NEW
HOME. KANISHKA
WOULD LOVE THE
COMPANY.**

**TWO FAMILIES, ONCE STRANGERS, NOW WALK
TOGETHER INTO A NIGHT THAT WILL CHANGE
THEIR STORIES FOREVER.**



**WEALTH BUILDS
HOUSES, BUT STORIES
BUILD HOMES**

WELCOME, COLONEL!
IT IS AN HONOR TO
HAVE YOU AND YOUR
FAMILY IN OUR NEW
HOME

THANK YOU,
RAJESH. IT'S A JOY
TO BE HERE.

**TWO FAMILIES, ONCE STRANGERS, NOW
WALK TOGETHER INTO A SHARED NIGHT
THAT WILL CHANGE THEIR STORIES
FOREVER**

TRY THE MALAI KOFTA,
COLONEL. IT'S A
SPECIALTY FROM OUR
FAMILY KITCHEN IN
KASHI

EXCELLENT! A MAN
WHO KNOWS HIS
BUSINESS AND HIS
FOOD IS A RARE,
RAJESH.

**FINDING COMMON GROUND
IN THE SIMPLE ACT OF
SHARING A MEAL.**

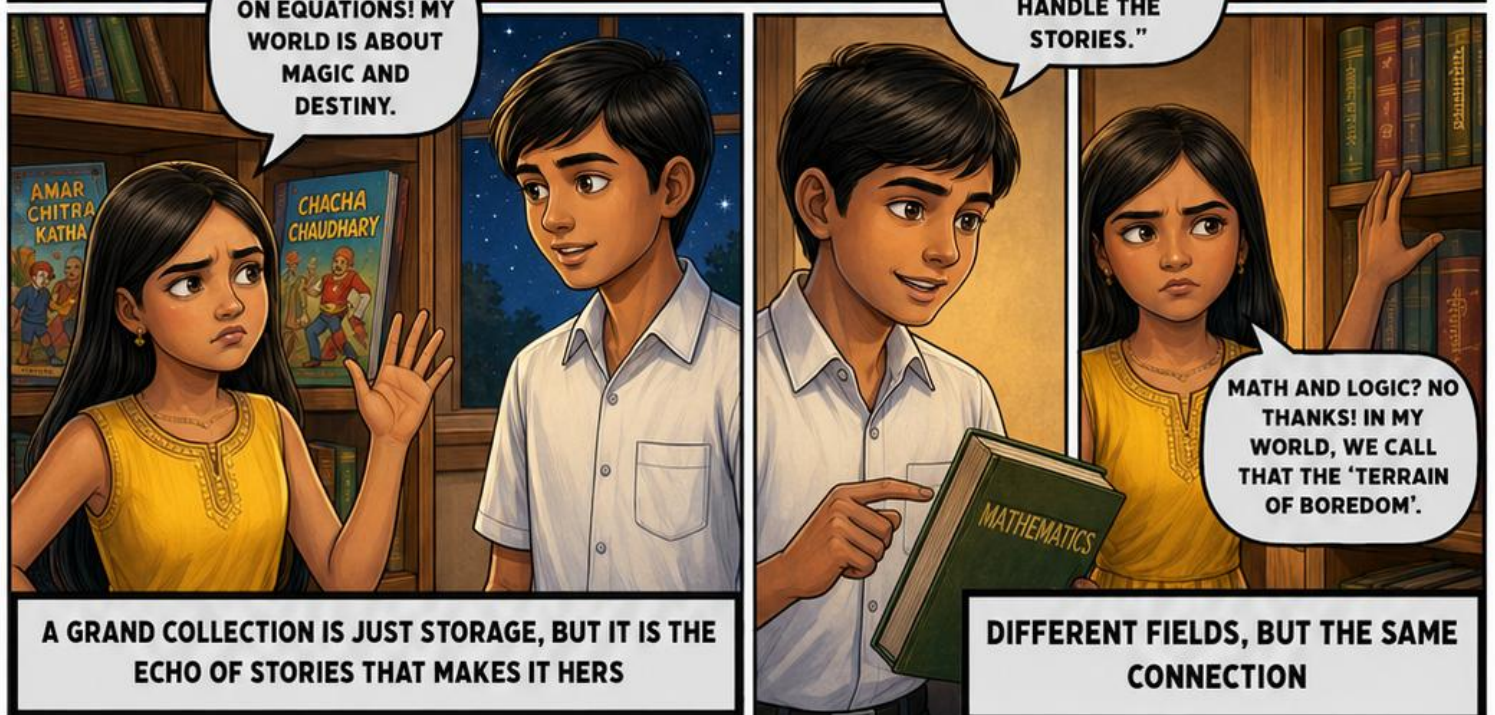
I AGREE. IN BUSINESS, WE
CALL IT NAVIGATING THE
TERRAIN. DIFFERENT FIELDS,
SAME DISCIPLINE.

VRINDAVAN IS PEACEFUL,
BUT MANAGING LOGISTICS
HERE IS QUITE A TASK
COMPARED TO THE
BORDER.

COME ON THEN,
SOLDIER BOY. LET'S SEE
IF YOU CAN HANDLE MY
WORLD.

KANISHKA, BETA... WHY DON'T
YOU SHOW AVNISH AROUND?
SHOW HIM THAT MASSIVE
BOOK COLLECTION YOU
BROUGHT FROM KASHI.

**A GRAND HOUSE IS JUST A BUILDING, BUT IT IS THE
ECHO OF CHILDREN'S LAUGHTER THAT MAKES IT A
HOME.**



THE JOURNEY THAT BEGAN WITH A SHARED GLANCE IN A DUSTY VRINDAVAN LIBRARY HAD LED THEM HERE... TO A ROOM FILLED WITH SHADOWS AND A SINGLE, IMPOSSIBLE LIGHT.

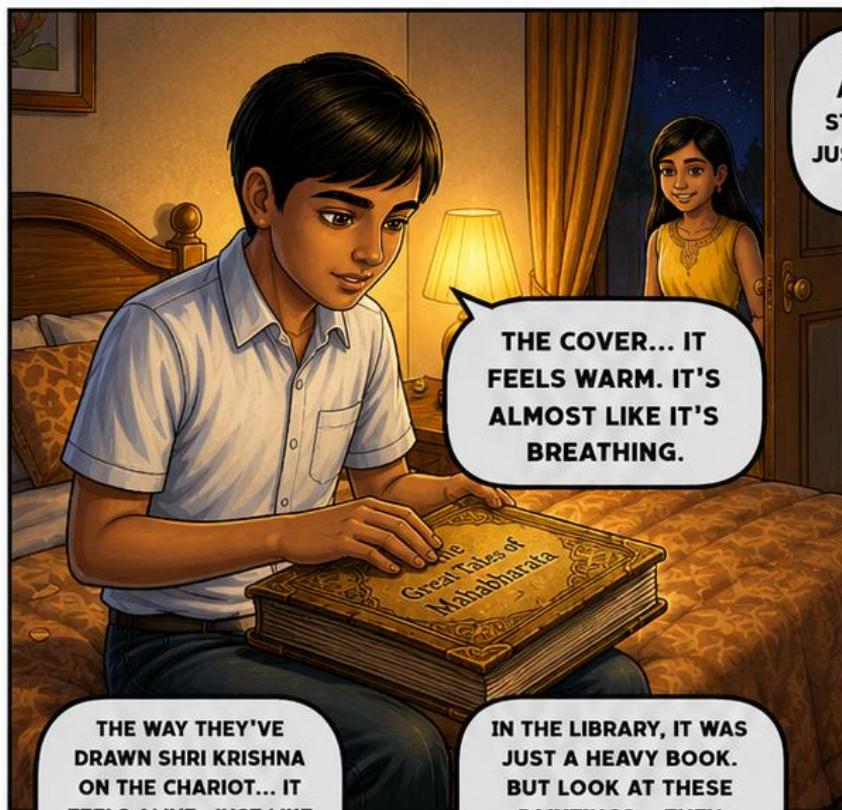


**SOMETHING FEELS...
DIFFERENT TONIGHT,
AVNISH. LOOK AT THE
TABLE.**

**KANISHKA, LOOK! IT'S
THE SAME COPY OF
'THE GREAT TALES OF
MAHABHARAT' FROM
THE SHOP!**

**MY PAPA WAS RIGHT.
SOME STORIES AREN'T
JUST READ... THEY ARE
LIVED.**

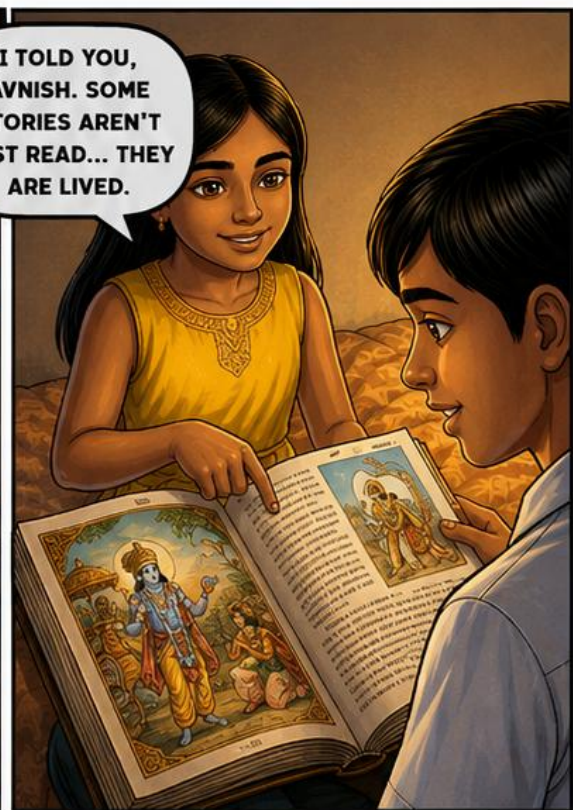
**OLD STORIES NEVER FADE. THEY ALWAYS FIND
THEIR WAY BACK.**



THE COVER... IT FEELS WARM. IT'S ALMOST LIKE IT'S BREATHING.

THE WAY THEY'VE DRAWN SHRI KRISHNA ON THE CHARIOT... IT FEELS ALIVE. JUST LIKE YOU SAID BACK AT THE SHOP.

IN THE LIBRARY, IT WAS JUST A HEAVY BOOK. BUT LOOK AT THESE PAINTINGS... THEY CARRY THE SOUL OF VRINDAVAN.



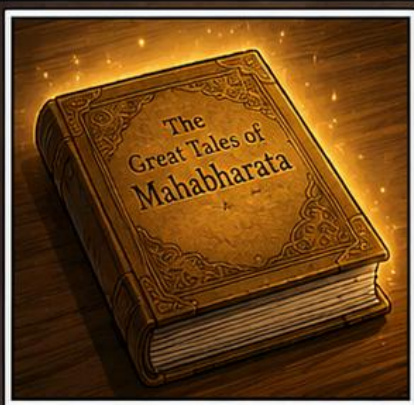
I TOLD YOU, AVNISH. SOME STORIES AREN'T JUST READ... THEY ARE LIVED.



OLD STORIES NEVER FADE. THEY ALWAYS FIND THEIR WAY BACK TO THOSE WHO NEED THEM

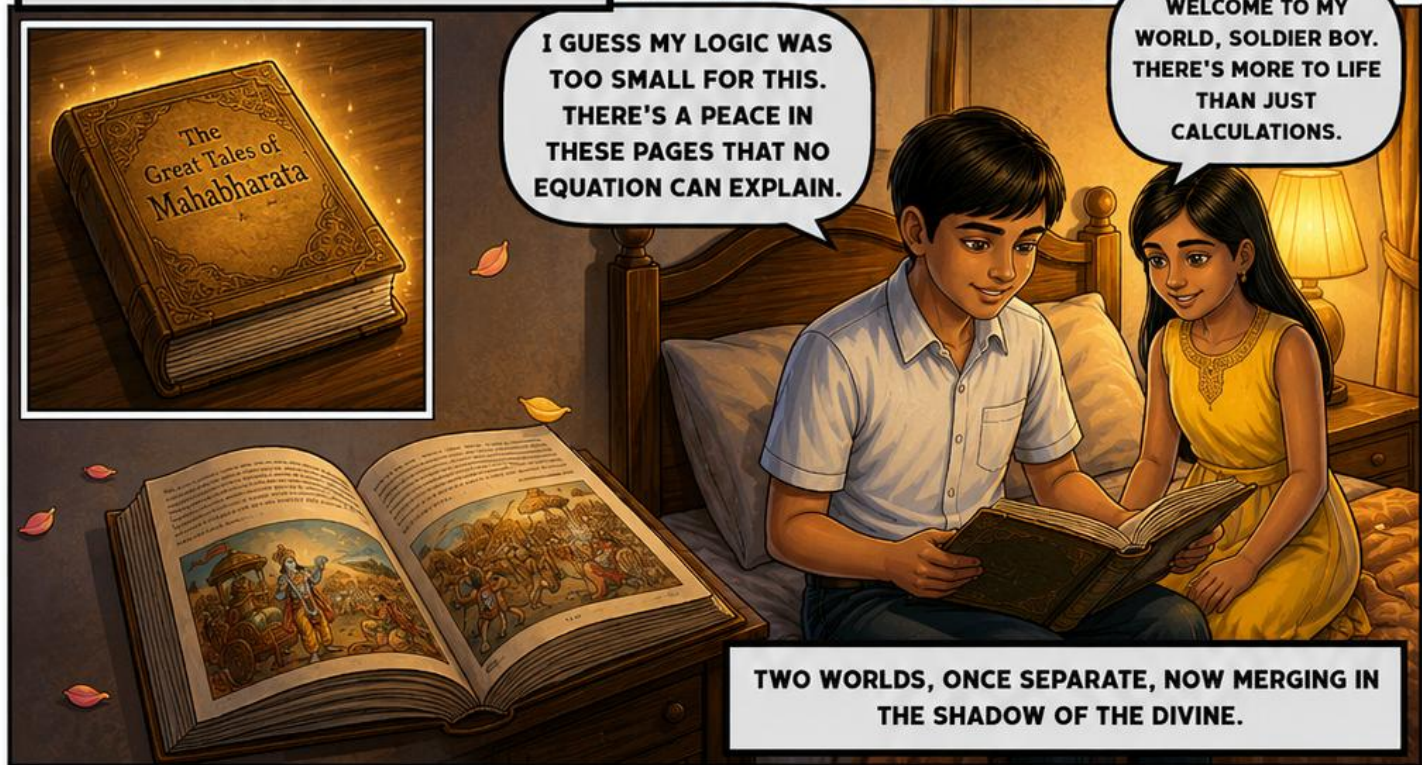


YOUR TACTICAL GUIDES TEACH HOW TO FIGHT... BUT THIS TEACHES YOU WHY WE FIGHT. IT'S A COMPLETELY DIFFERENT LEVEL.

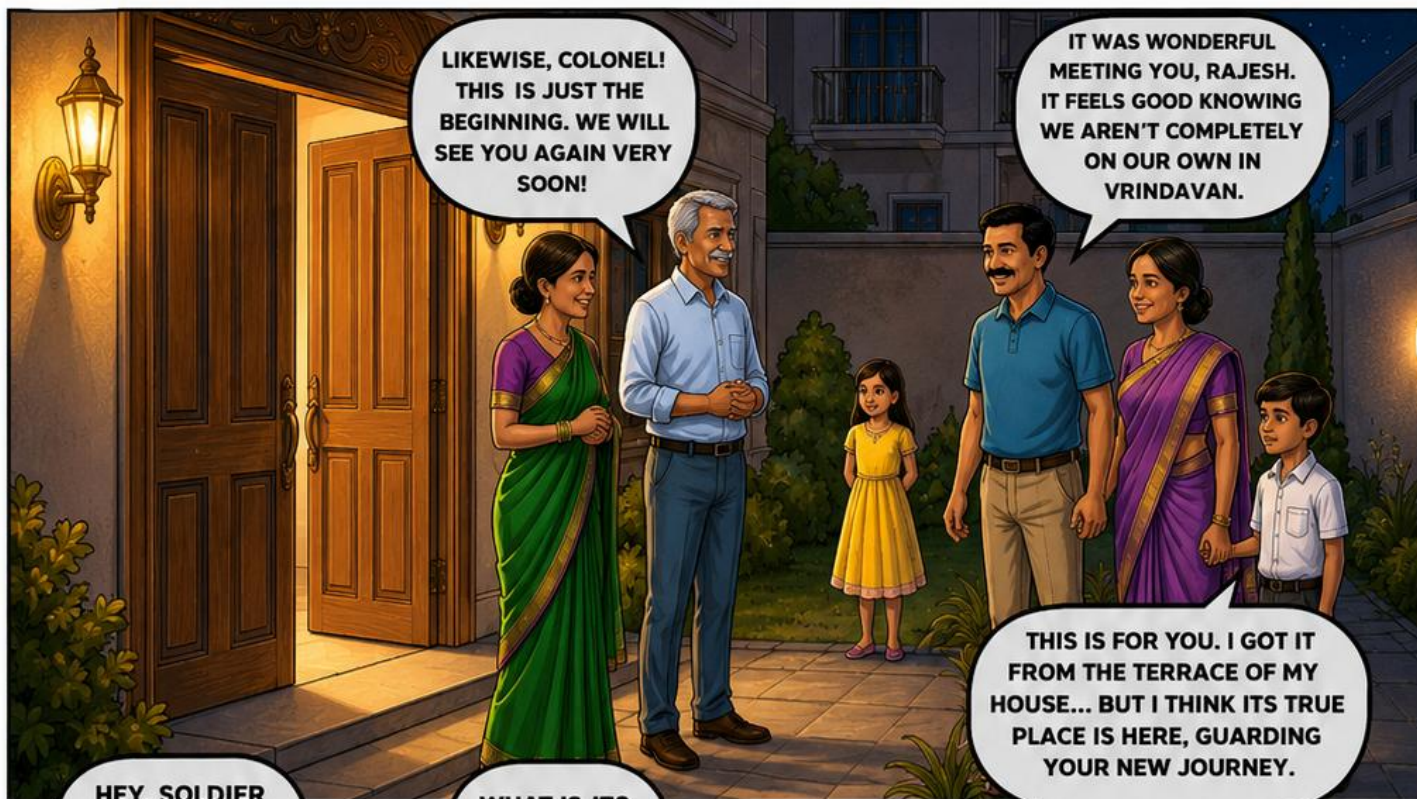


I GUESS MY LOGIC WAS TOO SMALL FOR THIS. THERE'S A PEACE IN THESE PAGES THAT NO EQUATION CAN EXPLAIN.

WELCOME TO MY WORLD, SOLDIER BOY. THERE'S MORE TO LIFE THAN JUST CALCULATIONS.



TWO WORLDS, ONCE SEPARATE, NOW MERGING IN THE SHADOW OF THE DIVINE.





**UNDER THE SILENT VRINDAVAN SKY, HE HELD A
GIFT THAT MEANT EVERYTHING TO HIM... EVEN
IF THE HEART THAT GAVE IT WOULD NEVER
TRULY BE HIS.**

**A NEW DAWN IN VRINDAVAN
BRINGS A CANVAS OF FRESH
BEGINNINGS...**

**NERVOUS ABOUT
THE NEW SCHOOL,
SON? JUST
REMEMBER, A
SOLDIER ADAPTS TO
EVERY GROUND.**

**I KNOW,
PAPA. I'M
READY**

**NEW CITY, NEW
FACES... LET'S SEE
WHAT THIS PLACE
HAS IN STORE FOR
ME.**

**WISDOM IS THE KEY
EXCEPT ON EXAM DAYS.**

ENTRANCE

**G. D. PUBLIC SCHOOL
ESTD. 1947**

**STEPPING INTO THE UNKNOWN,
WHERE EVERY CORNER HOLDS A
NEW STORY**

**CLASS 11th - C
COMMERCE SECTION** ★

**BUT SOME ENTRIES ARE DESTINED
TO CHANGE EVERYTHING.**

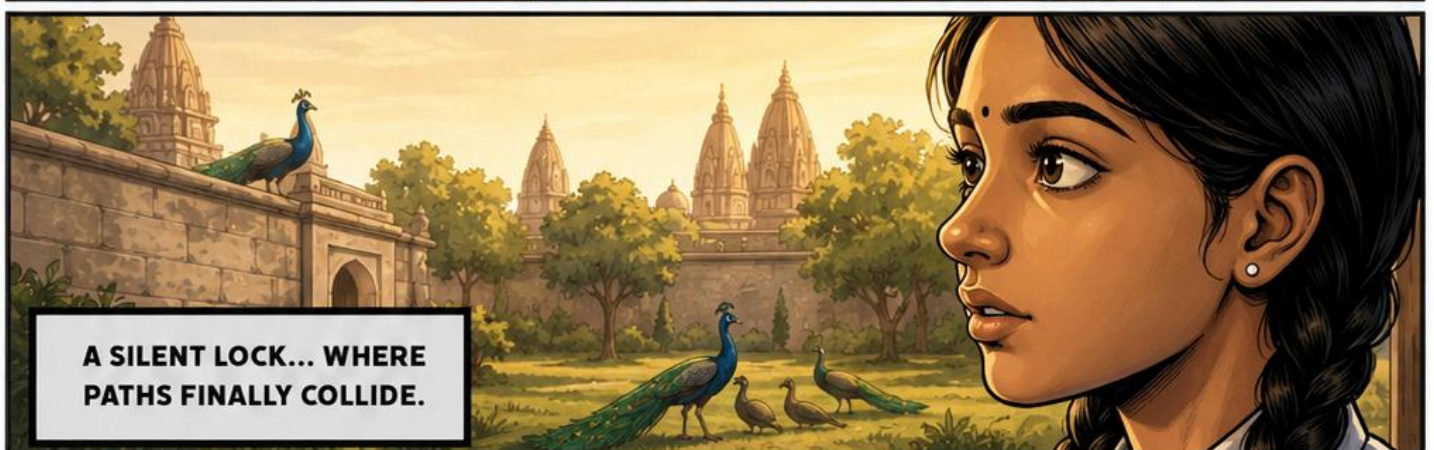
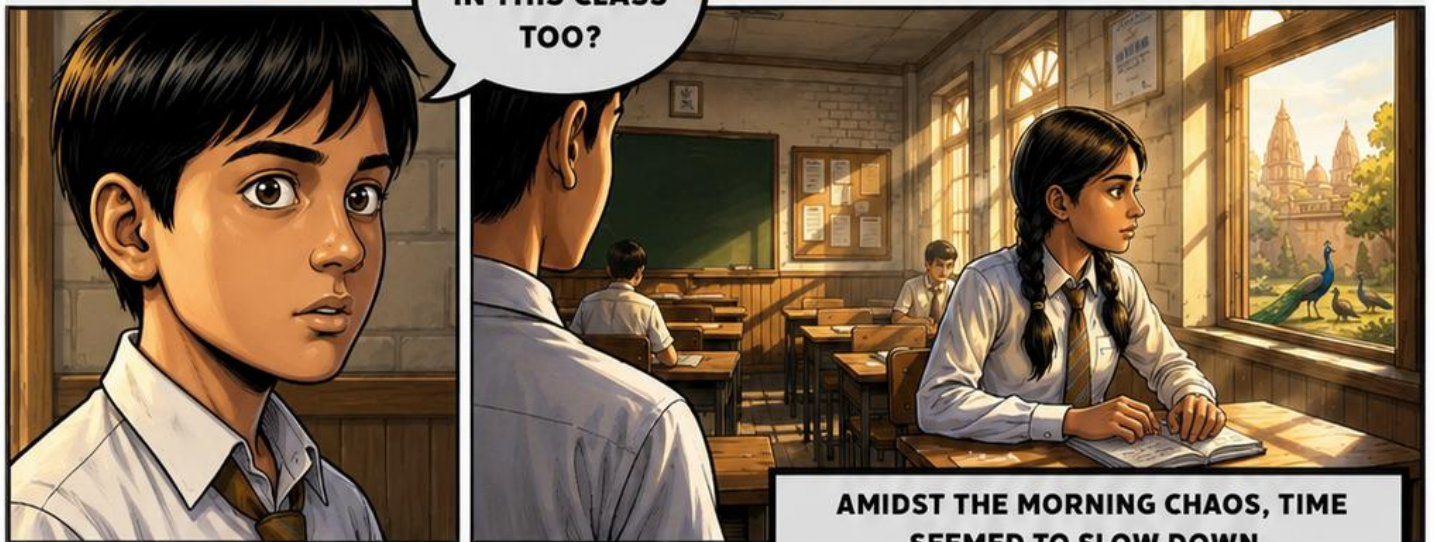
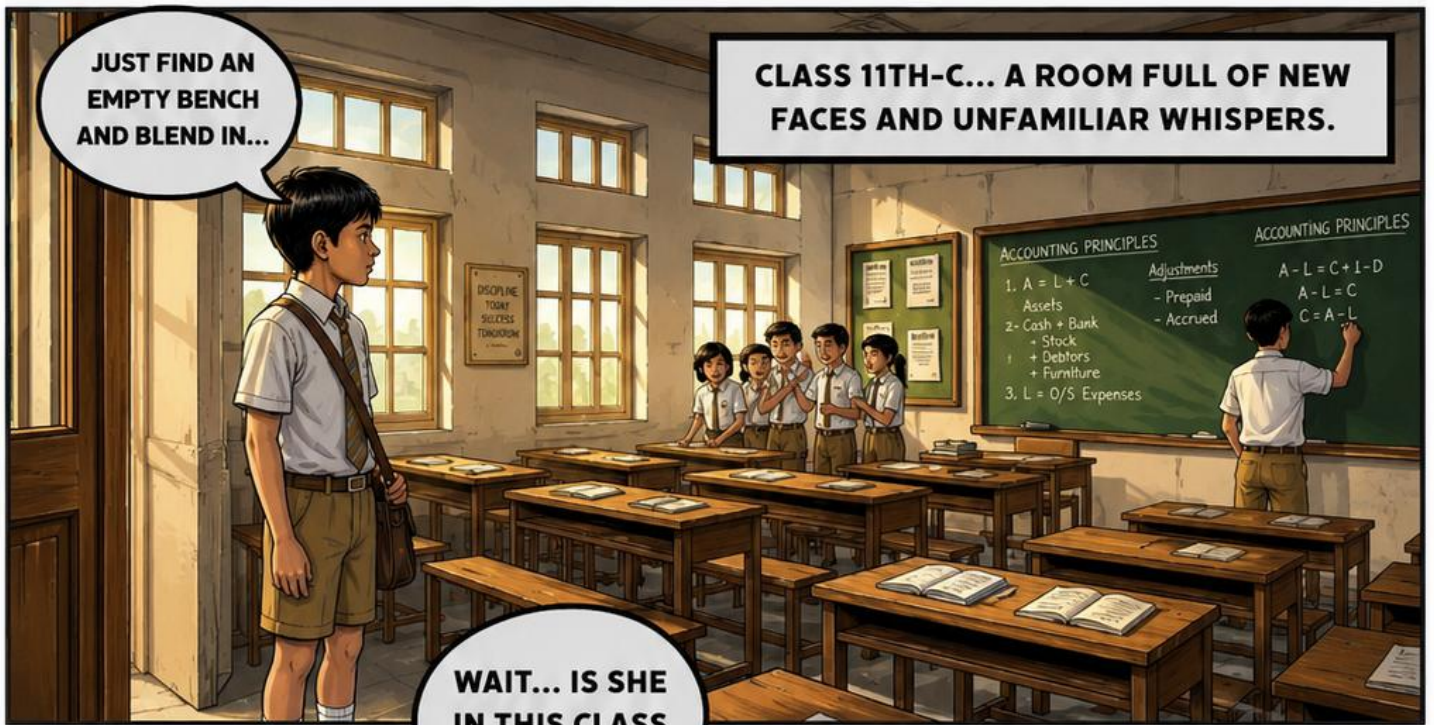
JUST FIND AN
EMPTY BENCH
AND BLEND IN...

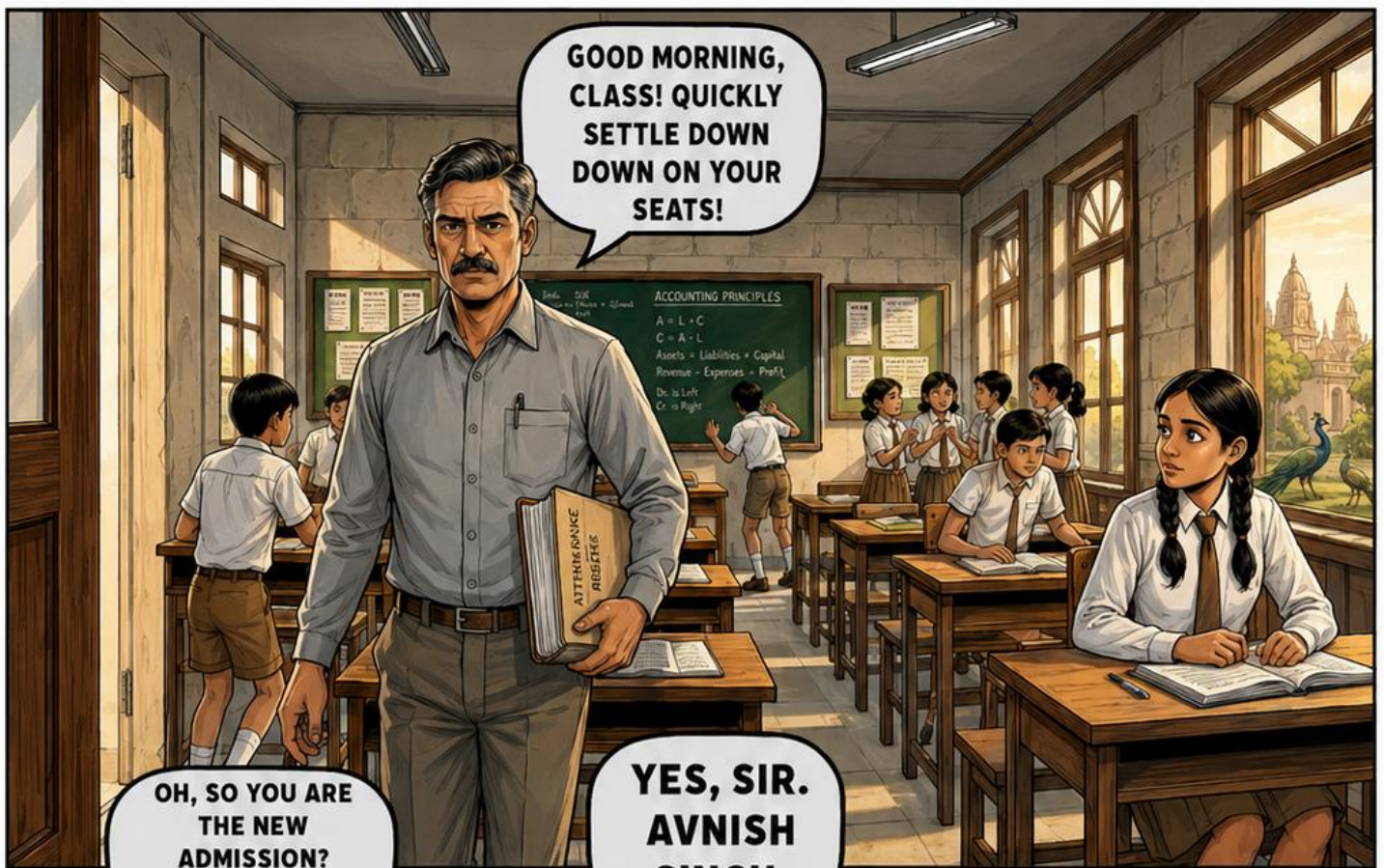
CLASS 11TH-C... A ROOM FULL OF NEW
FACES AND UNFAMILIAR WHISPERS.

WAIT... IS SHE
IN THIS CLASS
TOO?

AMIDST THE MORNING CHAOS, TIME
SEEMED TO SLOW DOWN.

A SILENT LOCK... WHERE
PATHS FINALLY COLLIDE.

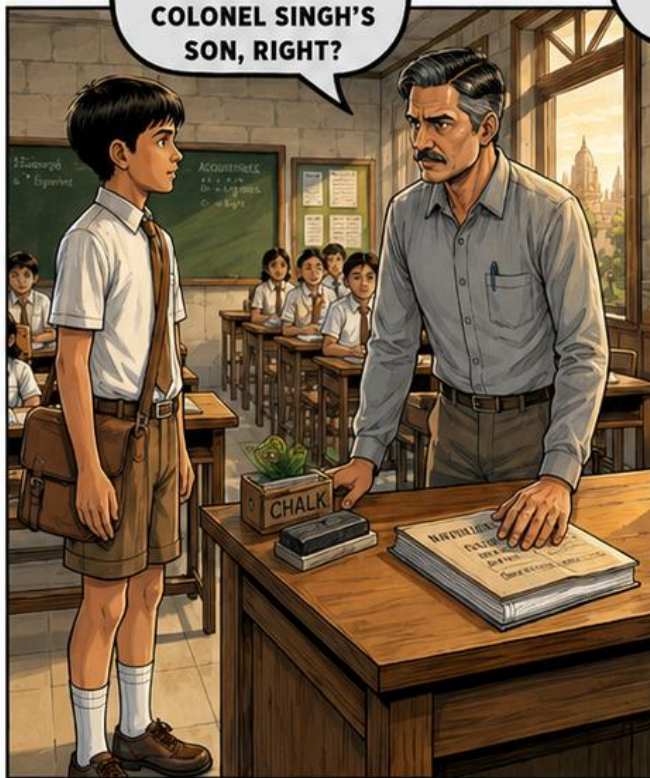




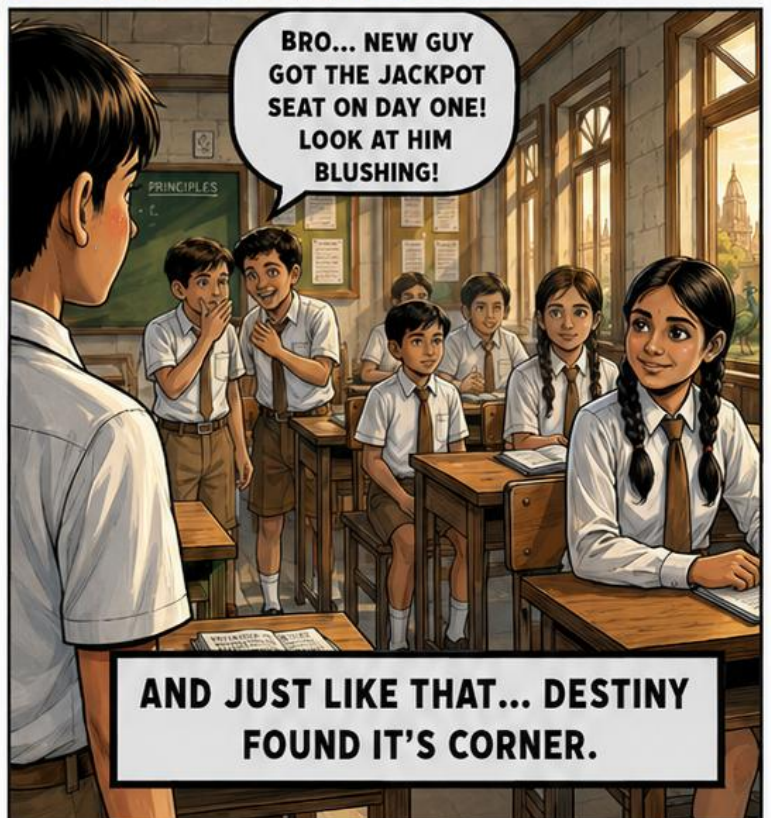
GOOD MORNING,
CLASS! QUICKLY
SETTLE DOWN
ON YOUR
SEATS!

OH, SO YOU ARE
THE NEW
ADMISSION?
COLONEL SINGH'S
SON, RIGHT?

YES, SIR.
AVNISH
SINGH.



ALRIGHT, GO AND
TAKE THAT VACANT
SEAT IN THE FIRST
ROW, NEXT TO THE
WINDOW



BRO... NEW GUY
GOT THE JACKPOT
SEAT ON DAY ONE!
LOOK AT HIM
BLUSHING!

AND JUST LIKE THAT... DESTINY
FOUND IT'S CORNER.



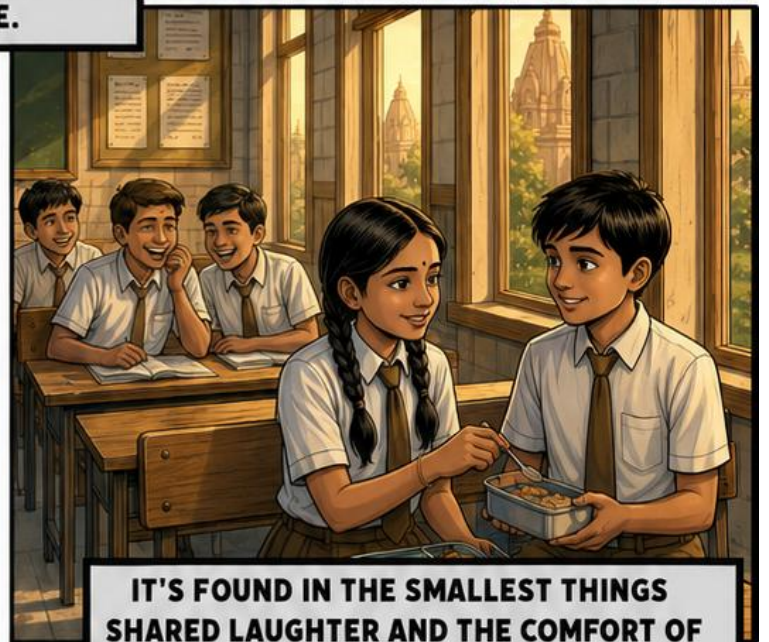
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KHWAAB
PART-1

**DESTINY DOESN'T MAKE A SOUND. IT JUST WAITS
FOR THE PERFECT MOMENT.**



**THEY SAY LOVE AND FRIENDSHIP ARE DIFFERENT. BUT
HERE, THEY FEEL EXACTLY THE SAME.**

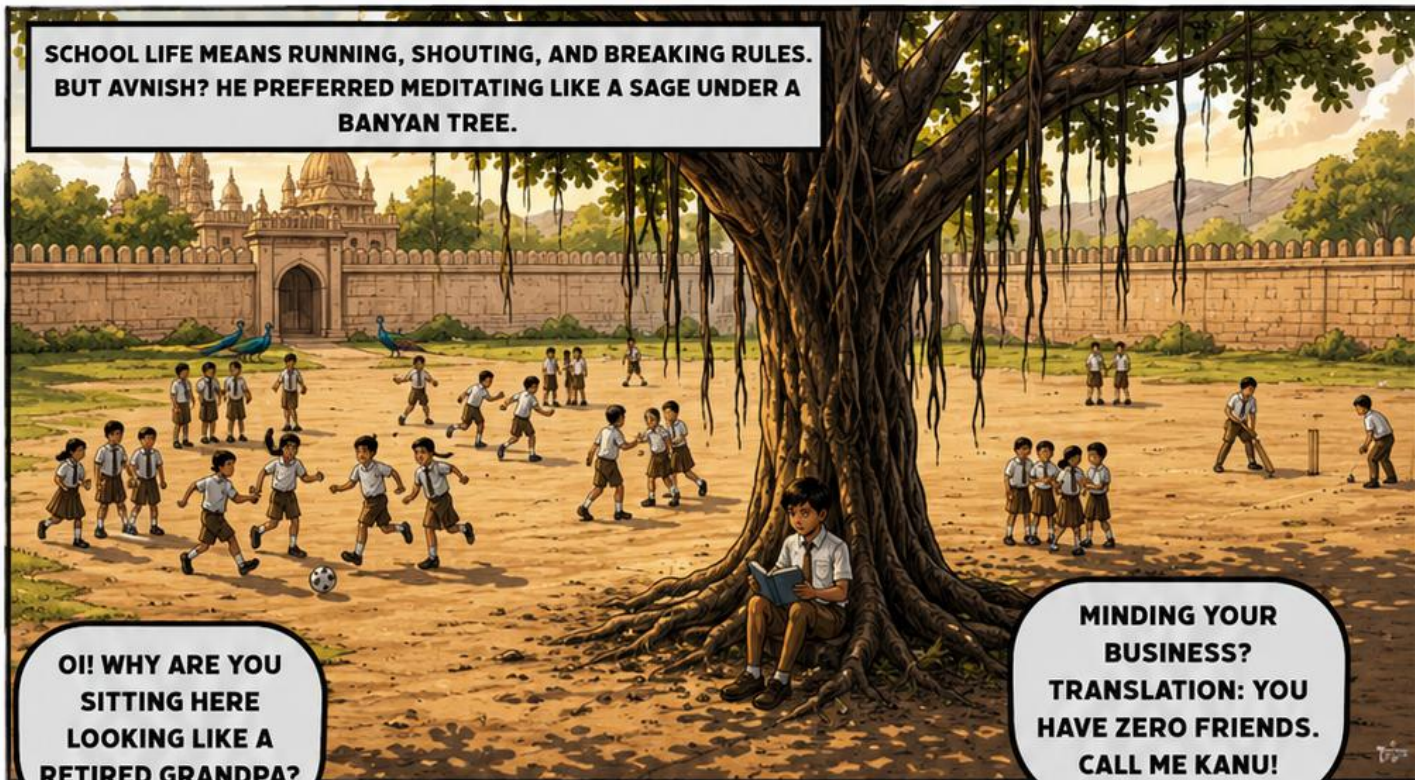


**IT'S FOUND IN THE SMALLEST THINGS
SHARED LAUGHTER AND THE COMFORT OF
JUST BEING TOGETHER.**



**AND JUST LIKE THAT, THE WORLD FADES AWAY.
BECAUSE WITH YOU, EVEN THE RAIN FEELS LIKE
SUNSHINE.**

**SCHOOL LIFE MEANS RUNNING, SHOUTING, AND BREAKING RULES.
BUT AVNISH? HE PREFERRED MEDITATING LIKE A SAGE UNDER A
BANYAN TREE.**



**OI! WHY ARE YOU
SITTING HERE
LOOKING LIKE A
RETIRED GRANDPA?**

**MINDING YOUR
BUSINESS?
TRANSLATION: YOU
HAVE ZERO FRIENDS.
CALL ME KANU!**



**I'M NOT A
GRANDPA! I'M
JUST... MINDING
MY OWN
BUSINESS.**



**KANU? THAT
SOUNDS LIKE A
TOMCAT'S
NAME.**



**EXCUSE ME?!
ANYWAY, LOOK AT
YOU... YOU ARE
LITERALLY AN
AVOCADO!**

**AN AVOCADO?!
WHAT IS
WRONG WITH
THIS SCHOOL?!**



OVER THE NEXT FEW WEEKS, AVNISH AND KANISHKA BECAME INSEPARABLE. TWO COMPLETELY DIFFERENT WORLDS BALANCING EACH OTHER OUT.

COME ON, TRY IT! MY MOM MADE SPECIAL ALOO-POORI TODAY.

UH... IS IT JUST ME, OR IS THIS PRACTICALLY 90% CHILI POWDER?!

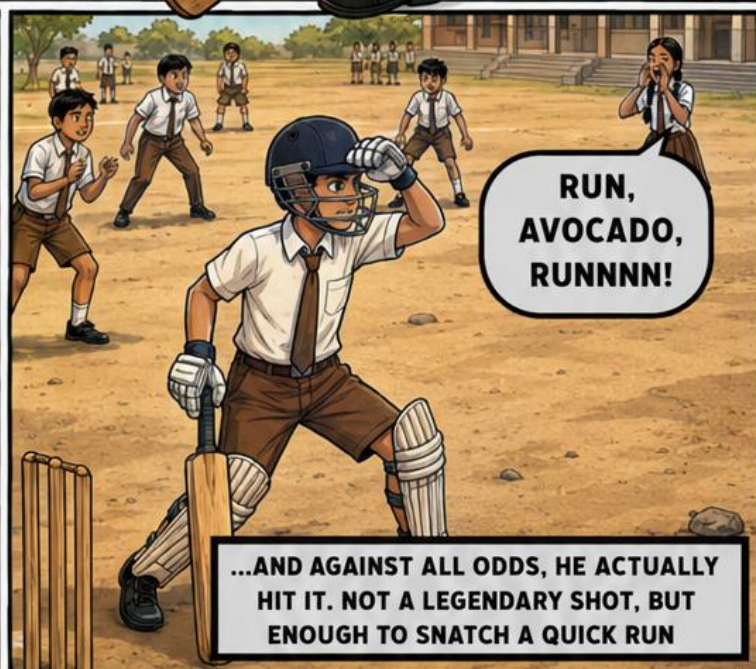
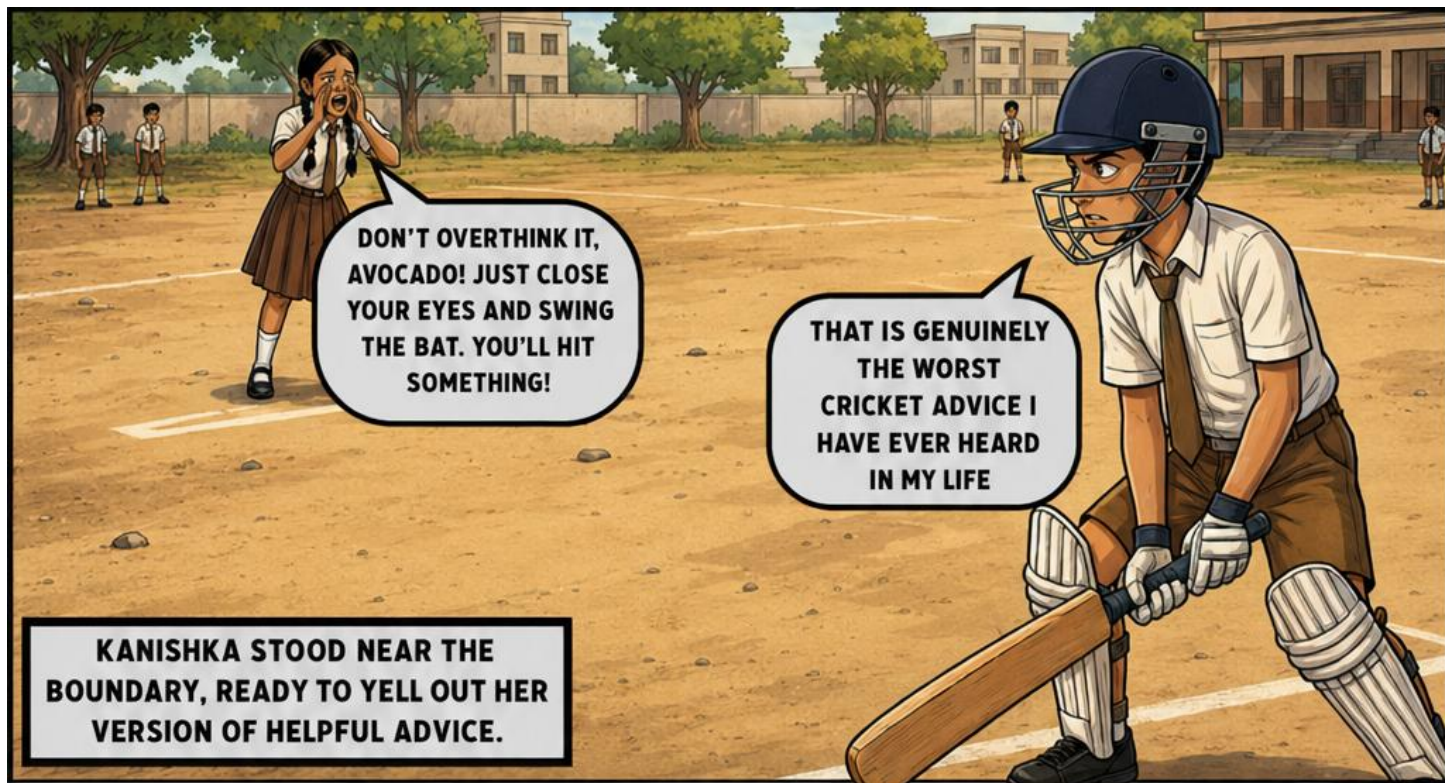
COME ON, AVOCOD!! YOU CAN'T JUST SIT UNDER THAT TREE EVERY SINGLE DAY. TODAY, YOU'RE OPENING THE BATTING LINEUP!

I TOLD YOU DON'T CALL ME THAT! AND I DON'T EVEN KNOW WHERE THE LEG-STUMP IS!

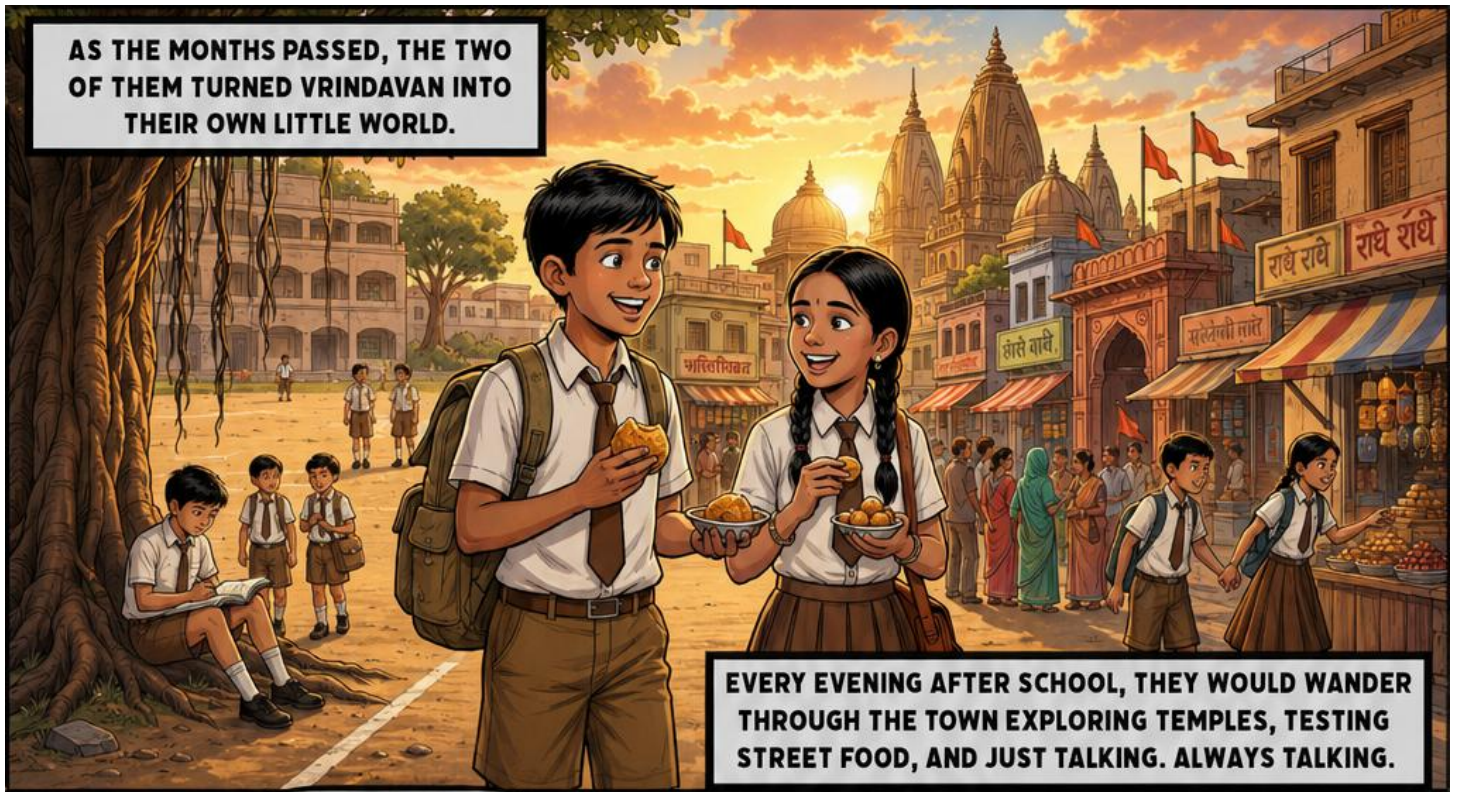
HE ENDED UP PLAYING ANYWAY. WHEN IT WAS HIS TURN TO BAT, HE WALKED TO THE CREASE LOOKING LIKE HE WAS WALKING INTO AN EXAM HE HADN'T STUDIED FOR.

IF I GET HIT BY A BOUNCER, I AM LEGALLY BLAMING YOU.

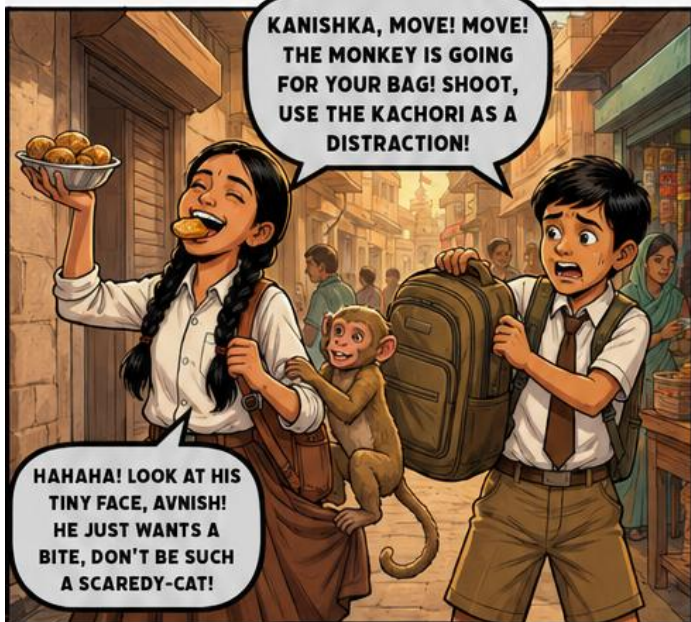
LOOK AT YOU ALL PADDED UP! TRY NOT TO GET OUT ON A GOLDEN DUCK, OKAY?



AS THE MONTHS PASSED, THE TWO OF THEM TURNED VRINDAVAN INTO THEIR OWN LITTLE WORLD.

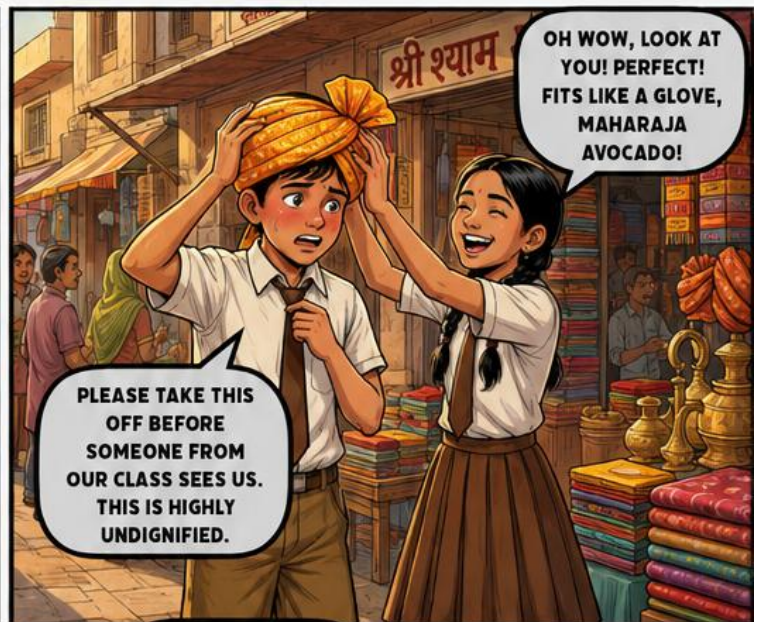


EVERY EVENING AFTER SCHOOL, THEY WOULD WANDER THROUGH THE TOWN EXPLORING TEMPLES, TESTING STREET FOOD, AND JUST TALKING. ALWAYS TALKING.



KANISHKA, MOVE! MOVE! THE MONKEY IS GOING FOR YOUR BAG! SHOOT, USE THE KACHORI AS A DISTRACTION!

HAHAHA! LOOK AT HIS TINY FACE, AVNISH! HE JUST WANTS A BITE, DON'T BE SUCH A SCAREDY-CAT!



OH WOW, LOOK AT YOU! PERFECT! FITS LIKE A GLOVE, MAHARAJA AVOCADO!

PLEASE TAKE THIS OFF BEFORE SOMEONE FROM OUR CLASS SEES US. THIS IS HIGHLY UNDIGNIFIED.

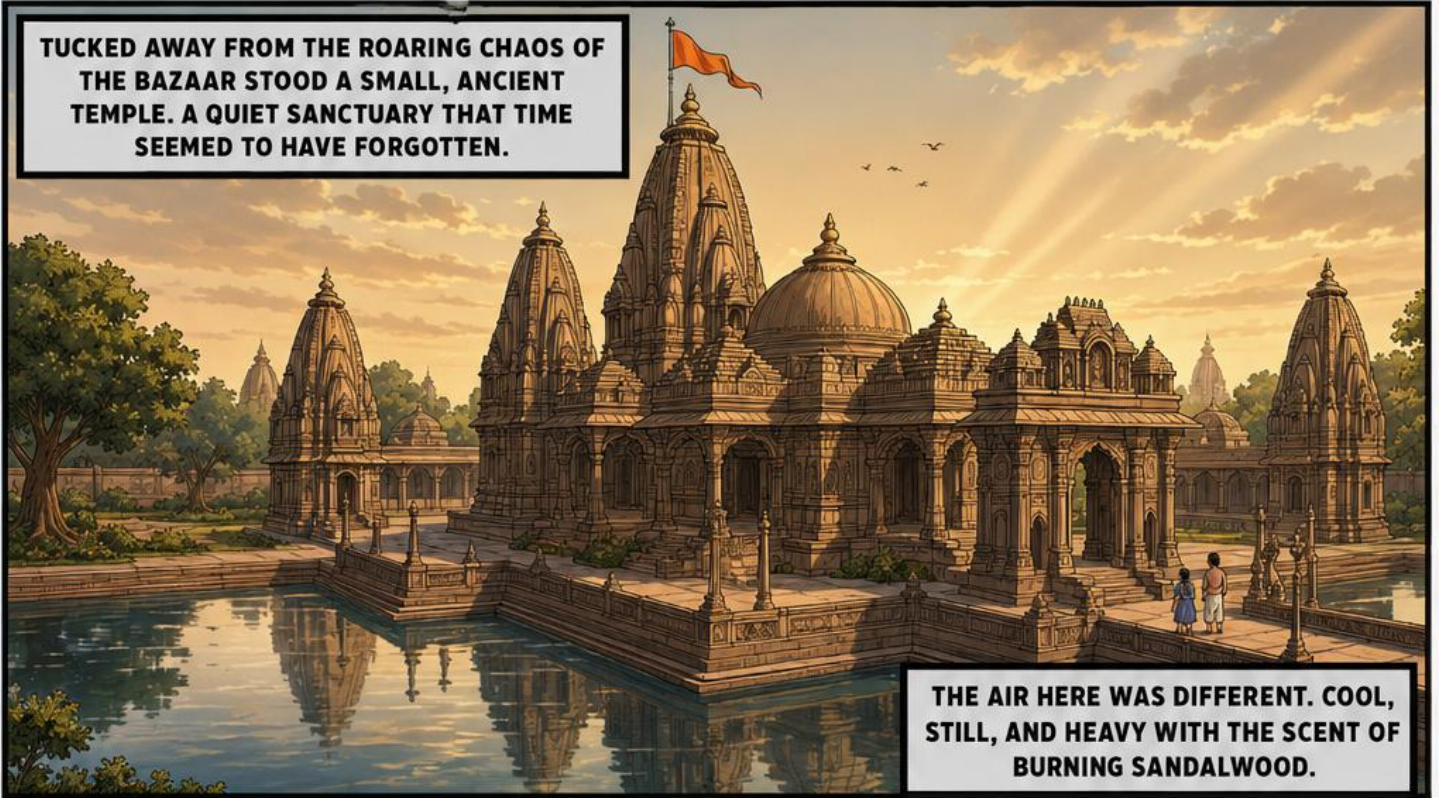


I DON'T KNOW, KANISHKA... IT LOOKS LIKE THE EXACT SPOT WHERE MAIN CHARACTERS IN HORROR MOVIES MAKE THEIR FINAL MISTAKES. CAN WE PLEASE HEAD BACK?

HEY! LOOK OVER THERE PAST THE BANGLE STALL. LET'S CHECK OUT THAT HIDDEN LANE!

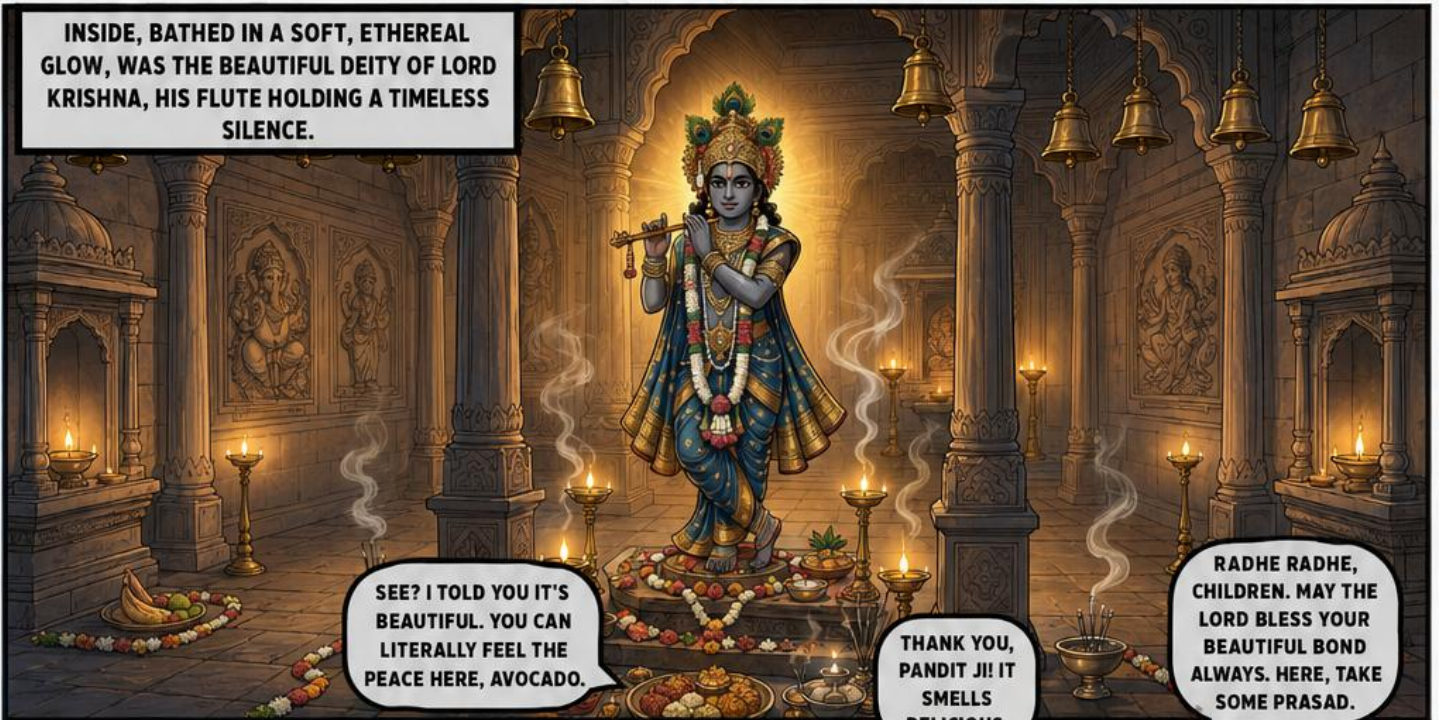
IT WAS A BLUR OF FOOD, FIGHTS, LAUGHTER, AND A STRANGE COMFORT THAT NEITHER OF THEM WANTED TO ADMIT.

TUCKED AWAY FROM THE ROARING CHAOS OF THE BAZAAR STOOD A SMALL, ANCIENT TEMPLE. A QUIET SANCTUARY THAT TIME SEEMED TO HAVE FORGOTTEN.



THE AIR HERE WAS DIFFERENT. COOL, STILL, AND HEAVY WITH THE SCENT OF BURNING SANDALWOOD.

INSIDE, BATHED IN A SOFT, ETHEREAL GLOW, WAS THE BEAUTIFUL DEITY OF LORD KRISHNA, HIS FLUTE HOLDING A TIMELESS SILENCE.



SEE? I TOLD YOU IT'S BEAUTIFUL. YOU CAN LITERALLY FEEL THE PEACE HERE, AVOCADO.

THANK YOU, PANDIT JI! IT SMELLS DELICIOUS.

RADHE RADHE, CHILDREN. MAY THE LORD BLESS YOUR BEAUTIFUL BOND ALWAYS. HERE, TAKE SOME PRASAD.



YEAH... YOU'RE ACTUALLY RIGHT FOR ONCE. IT MAKES YOU WANT TO JUST QUIET DOWN AND LOOK.



SHOULDN'T WE WAIT UNTIL WE STEP OUTSIDE THE TEMPLE PREMISES TO EAT IT, KANISHKA?





OH WOW, LOOK AT THEM GO! COME ON, WE ARE TOTALLY JOINING THE RACE!

FINDING A STRANGE COMFORT IN THE MIDDLE OF THE CHAOTIC DOWNPOUR.

ARE YOU SERIOUS? WE ARE LITERALLY COVERED IN MUD, AND YOU WANT TO RACE?

STOP COMPLAINING, SOLDIER BOY! YOU'RE A COLONEL'S SON AND YOU CAN'T EVEN FOLD PAPER? YOURS LOOKS LIKE A CRUMPLED NAPKIN!

I'M JUST MAKING IT STRONGER! YOURS MIGHT LOOK GOOD, BUT IT'S GOING TO SINK IN TWO SECONDS. JUST WATCH.

BOOM! INSTANT SHIPWRECK! TOLD YOU SO, AVNISH! MY BOAT COMPLETELY DESTROYED YOURS!



I'M NOT CRYING, IT'S JUST A PIECE OF PAPER, BUT FINE... THANKS FOR THE CHARITY, CAPTAIN BOSSY.



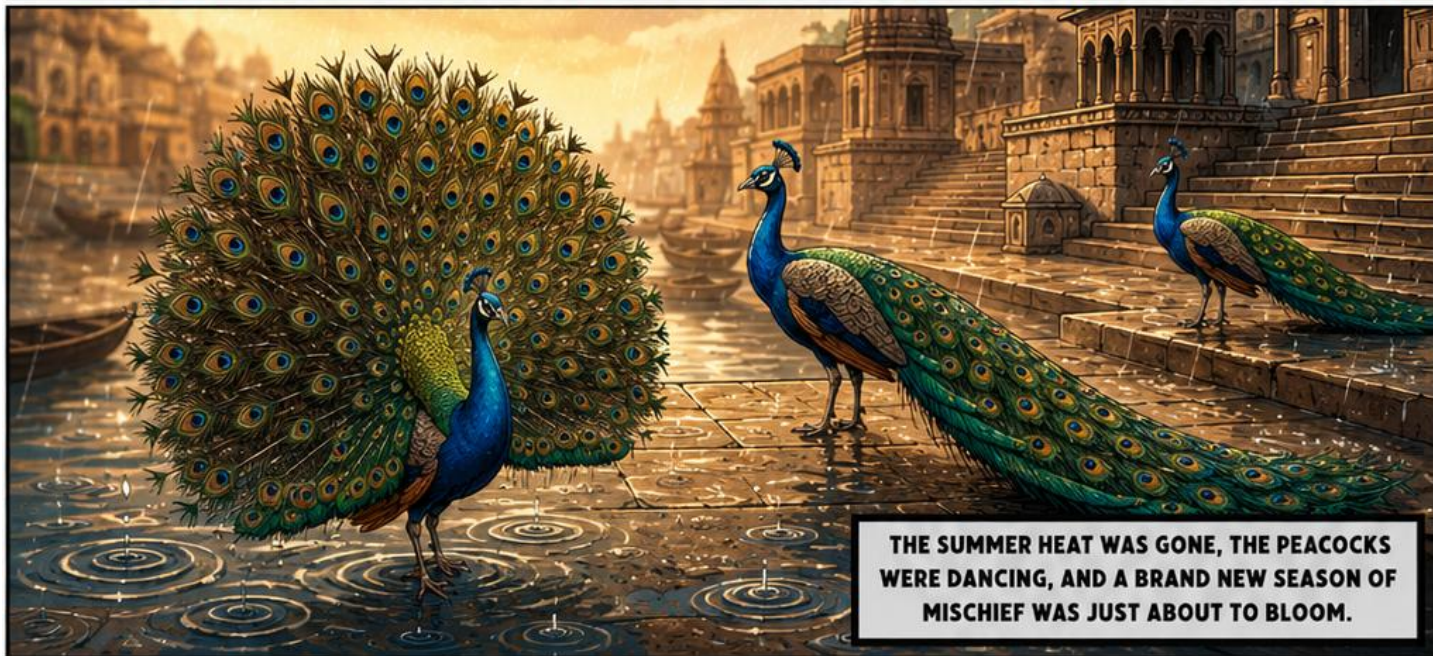
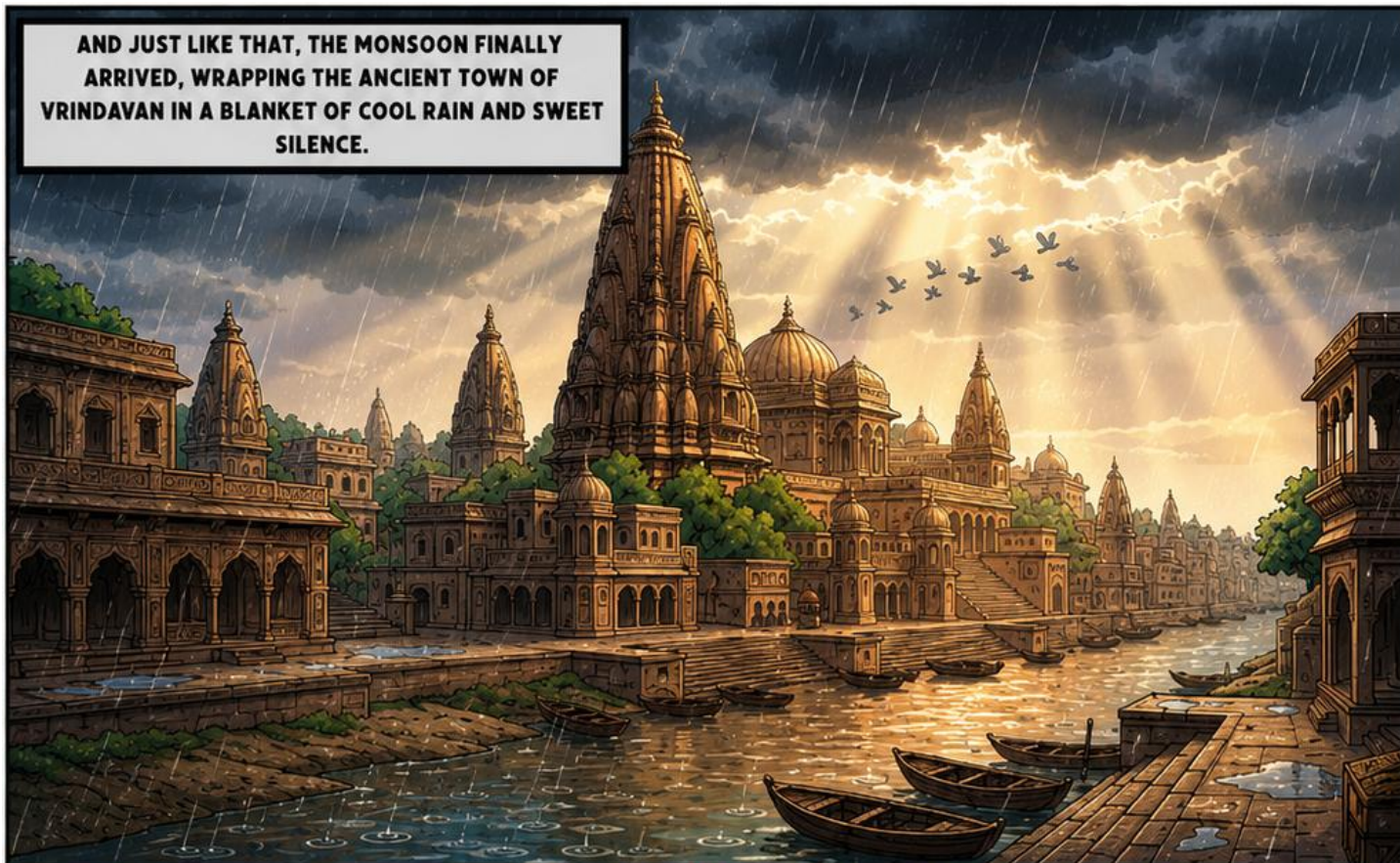
THAT WASN'T FAIR AT ALL. THE WATER IS MOVING FASTER ON YOUR SIDE, AND YOU TOTALLY STARTED EARLY.

SURE, BLAME THE WATER. HERE, SINCE I'M A NICE WINNER, YOU CAN HAVE MY CHAMPION BOAT. TRY NOT TO CRY.

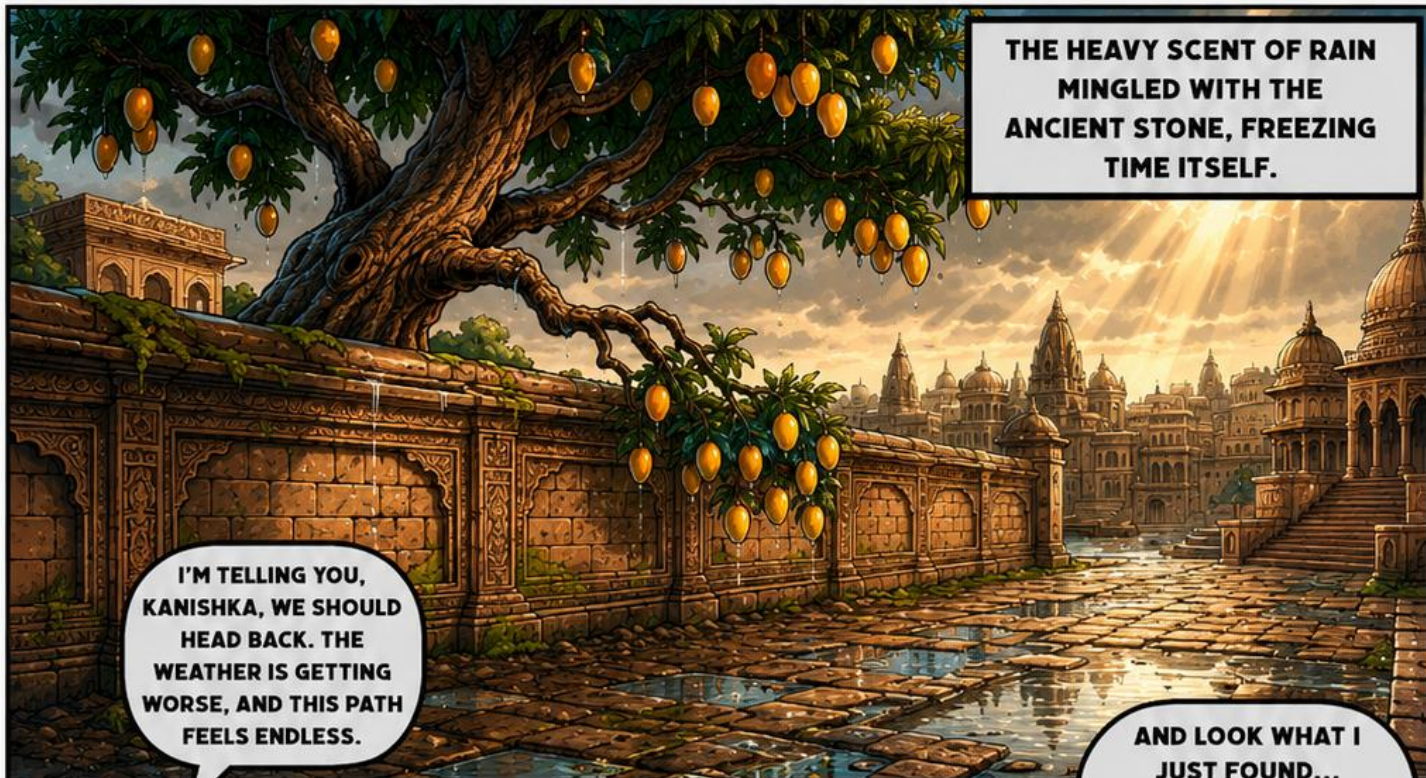


TWO COMPLETELY DIFFERENT WORLDS, WASHING AWAY IN THE SAME RAIN.

**AND JUST LIKE THAT, THE MONSOON FINALLY
ARRIVED, WRAPPING THE ANCIENT TOWN OF
VRINDAVAN IN A BLANKET OF COOL RAIN AND SWEET
SILENCE.**



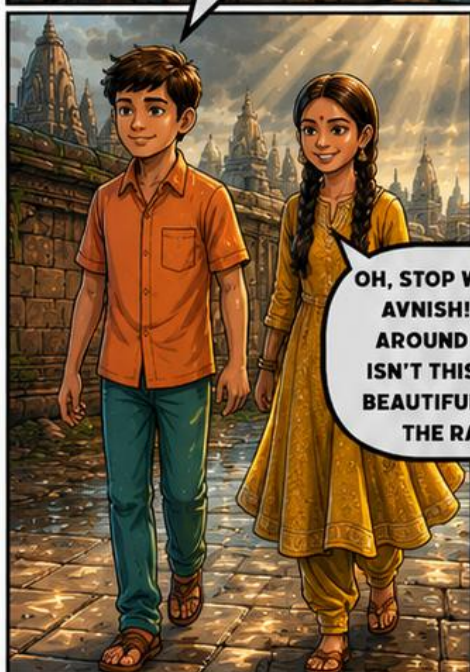
**THE SUMMER HEAT WAS GONE, THE PEACOCKS
WERE DANCING, AND A BRAND NEW SEASON OF
MISCHIEF WAS JUST ABOUT TO BLOOM.**



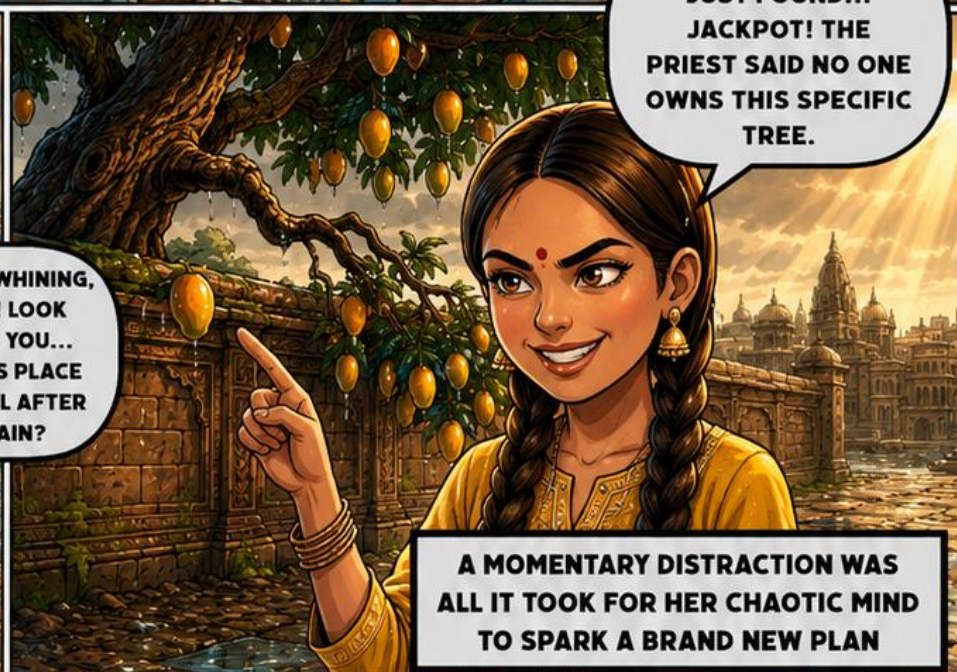
THE HEAVY SCENT OF RAIN
MINGLED WITH THE
ANCIENT STONE, FREEZING
TIME ITSELF.

I'M TELLING YOU,
KANISHKA, WE SHOULD
HEAD BACK. THE
WEATHER IS GETTING
WORSE, AND THIS PATH
FEELS ENDLESS.

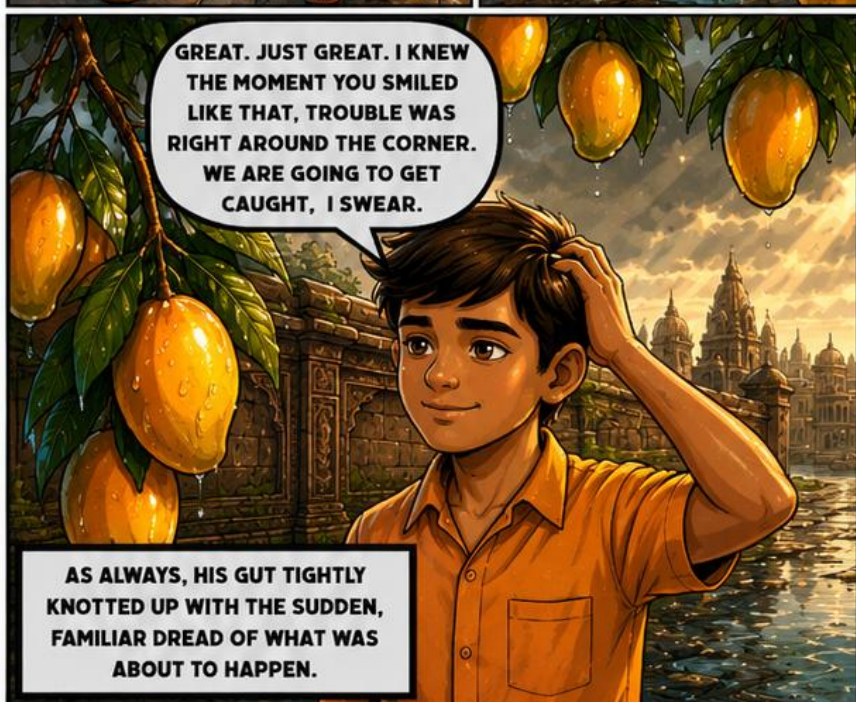
AND LOOK WHAT I
JUST FOUND...
JACKPOT! THE
PRIEST SAID NO ONE
OWNS THIS SPECIFIC
TREE.



OH, STOP WHINING,
AVNISH! LOOK
AROUND YOU...
ISN'T THIS PLACE
BEAUTIFUL AFTER
THE RAIN?

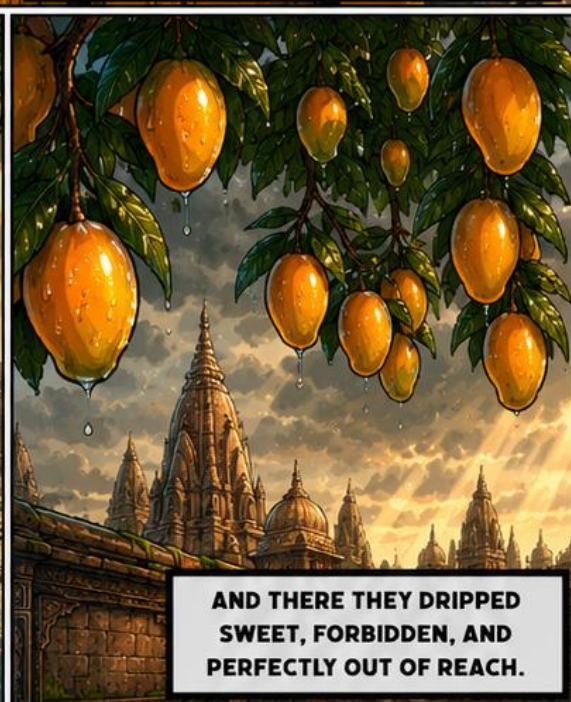


A MOMENTARY DISTRACTION WAS
ALL IT TOOK FOR HER CHAOTIC MIND
TO SPARK A BRAND NEW PLAN



GREAT. JUST GREAT. I KNEW
THE MOMENT YOU SMILED
LIKE THAT, TROUBLE WAS
RIGHT AROUND THE CORNER.
WE ARE GOING TO GET
CAUGHT, I SWEAR.

AS ALWAYS, HIS GUT TIGHTLY
KNOTTED UP WITH THE SUDDEN,
FAMILIAR DREAD OF WHAT WAS
ABOUT TO HAPPEN.



AND THERE THEY DRIPPED
SWEET, FORBIDDEN, AND
PERFECTLY OUT OF REACH.

DRIVEN BY THE PROMISE OF SWEETNESS, THEY SCALED THE ANCIENT STONE, LEAVING LOGIC ON THE GROUND.

HURRY UP, AVNISH! KEEP LOOKING AROUND, WE ARE ALMOST AT THE TOP BRANCH!

KANISHKA, WAIT UP! DON'T CLIMB SO FAST, THIS WALL IS SLIPPERY!

DID YOU HEAR THAT?! SWEAR I HEARD FOOTSTEPS... KANISHKA, PLEASE GRAB THEM QUICKLY, WE NEED TO GET DOWN!

RELAX, YOU WORRY TOO MUCH! LOOK AT THESE... THEY ARE PERFECTLY RIPE. JUST ONE MORE SECOND!

OKAY, I HATE TO ADMIT IT, BUT YOU WERE RIGHT... THIS IS INCREDIBLE.

SEE? I TOLD YOU SO! TOLD YOU IT WASN'T A BAD IDEA.

HEY! WHO IS THERE?! GET AWAY FROM THAT TREE RIGHT NOW!

BUT IN THE ETERNAL CITY, NO TRANSGRESSION GOES UNNOTICED FOR LONG.

PANIC SET IN AS THE HEAVY THUD OF FOOTSTEPS ECHOED BEHIND THEM.

RUN, KANISHKA! DON'T LOOK BACK, HE'S RIGHT BEHIND US!

I'M TRYING! AH THE MANGOES ARE SLIPPING!



PHIEW... THAT WAS WAY TOO CLOSE. I TOLD YOU WE'D GET CAUGHT!

BUT WE DIDN'T! AND LOOK, WE STILL MANAGED TO SAVE THE BEST ONES.



CATCHING THEIR BREATH IN THE SHADOWS, THE THRILL OF THE ESCAPE WASHED AWAY THE FEAR.

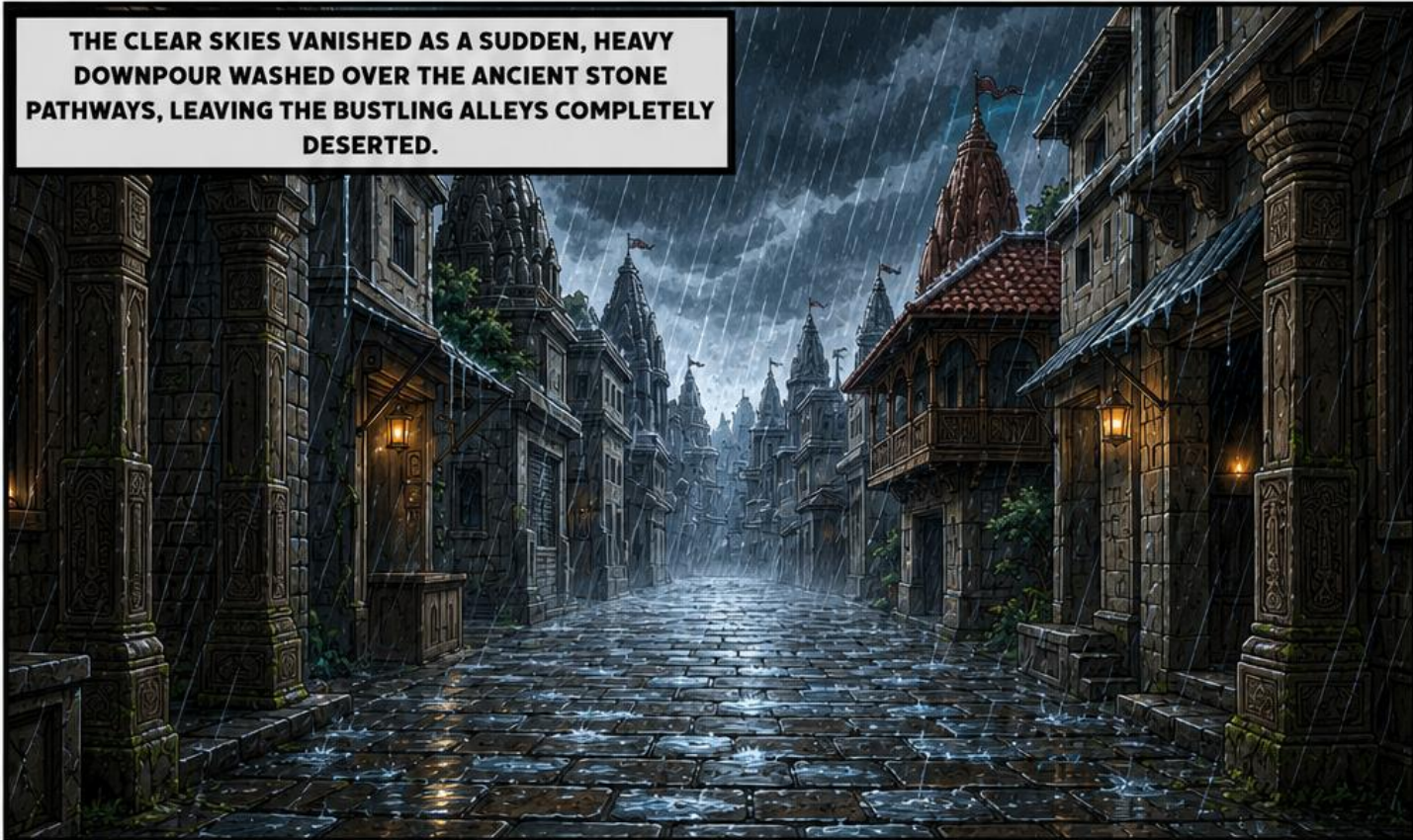
ALRIGHT, MAYBE IT WAS A LITTLE FUN. WHERE ARE WE HEADING NOW?

JUST WALKING TODAY. THE CITY BELONGS TO US.



BUT ABOVE THE LAUGHTER OF YOUTH, THE ANCIENT SKIES BEGAN TO CHURN ONCE MORE

THE CLEAR SKIES VANISHED AS A SUDDEN, HEAVY DOWNPOUR WASHED OVER THE ANCIENT STONE PATHWAYS, LEAVING THE BUSTLING ALLEYS COMPLETELY DESERTED.



KANISHKA! HURRY UP! WE NEED TO FIND SHELTER BEFORE THE WATER RISES TOO HIGH!

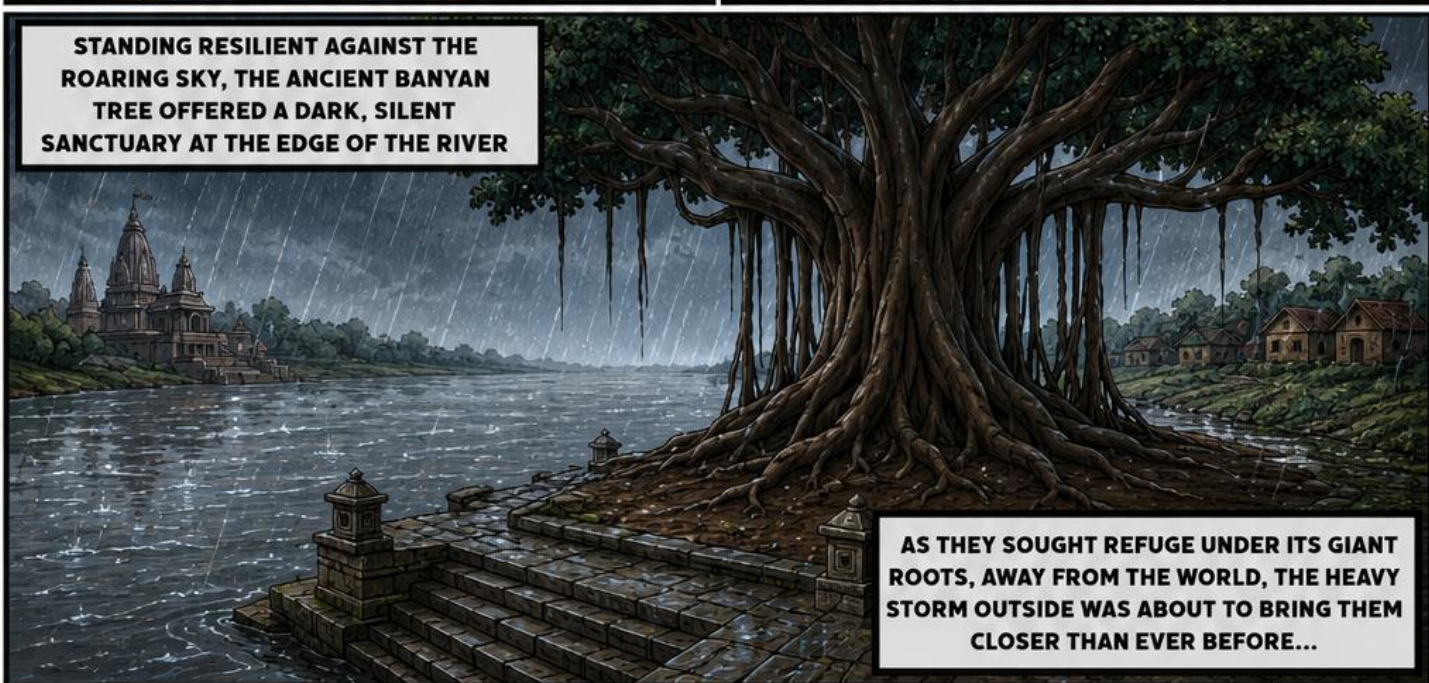
THE RIVERBANK IS JUST AHEAD! THE BIG TREE WILL PROTECT US FROM THE RAIN!



EVERY STEP BECAME HEAVIER AS THE PATHWAYS TURNED INTO A RUSHING TORRENT OF MUD AND WATER.



STANDING RESILIENT AGAINST THE ROARING SKY, THE ANCIENT BANYAN TREE OFFERED A DARK, SILENT SANCTUARY AT THE EDGE OF THE RIVER



AS THEY SOUGHT REFUGE UNDER ITS GIANT ROOTS, AWAY FROM THE WORLD, THE HEAVY STORM OUTSIDE WAS ABOUT TO BRING THEM CLOSER THAN EVER BEFORE...

FORGETTING THE STORM AND HIS OWN EXHAUSTION, HE TURNED BACK WITHOUT A SECOND THOUGHT



THE PLAYFUL TEASING VANISHED, REPLACED BY A QUIET, FIERCE CONCERN



NO... I TRIED TO STAND, BUT I CAN'T PUT ANY WEIGHT ON IT.

LET ME SEE... IT'S SWOLLEN. CAN YOU MOVE IT AT ALL?

AVNISH, NO... YOU'LL SLIP ON THESE WET STAIRS.

KANU. GET ON MY BACK.

SOMETHING ABOUT THE WAY HE USED HER NICKNAME NOT MOCKING, JUST STEADY AND PROTECTIVE MADE HER STOP ARGUING.

YOU DIDN'T HAVE TO DO THIS...

YES, I DID. NOW HOLD ON TIGHT. THE TREE IS JUST AT THE TOP.



SOMETIMES, FRIENDSHIP ISN'T ABOUT DEEP WORDS OR PROMISES. IT'S SIMPLY ABOUT THE EFFORT THAT SAYS: "AS LONG AS I AM HERE, YOU DON'T HAVE TO FACE THE STORM ALONE." IT'S THAT RARE, UNSPOKEN BOND WHERE ANOTHER PERSON'S PAIN BECOMES YOURS TO CARRY.



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KHWAAB

PART-1

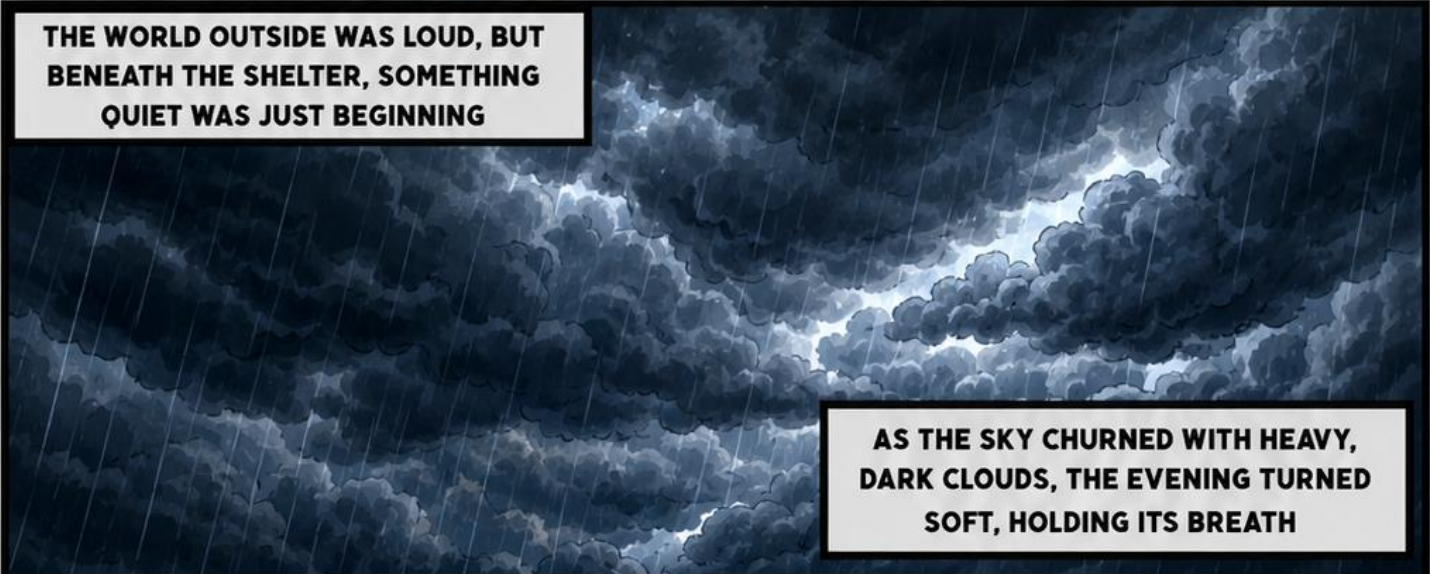


A detailed illustration of the interior of an ancient temple. The room is filled with ornate stone pillars and arches, some featuring carved figures. Several lit oil lamps provide a warm, golden light. The floor is made of large stone tiles, some of which are wet and reflective. A large, arched opening on the left side of the frame looks out onto a dark, rainy landscape with a river and distant hills. The overall atmosphere is one of quiet solitude amidst a powerful storm outside.

**SAFE BEHIND THE ANCIENT STONE
PILLARS, THE ROARING STORM OUTSIDE
FELT LIKE A WORLD AWAY**

A detailed illustration of a massive, ancient banyan tree with thick, gnarled roots that spread out over a stone platform and into a river. The tree's canopy is dense and dark. In the background, across the river, a small temple with a tall spire is visible under a dark, rainy sky. The scene is filled with the sound of rain falling on the leaves and the water.

**OUTSIDE, THE GREAT BANYAN TREE STOOD
RESILIENT, ITS DEEP ROOTS GUARDING THE
EDGE OF THE RUSHING RIVER**

A detailed illustration of a dark, stormy sky. Heavy, dark clouds are filled with rain, which is falling in thick, vertical lines. A bright, white light source, possibly the moon or a break in the clouds, is visible in the center, creating a dramatic contrast with the dark surroundings. The overall mood is one of intense, yet strangely calm, power.

**THE WORLD OUTSIDE WAS LOUD, BUT
BENEATH THE SHELTER, SOMETHING
QUIET WAS JUST BEGINNING**

**AS THE SKY CHURNED WITH HEAVY,
DARK CLOUDS, THE EVENING TURNED
SOFT, HOLDING ITS BREATH**

AS THE STORM FINALLY PASSED, THE EVENING TURNED SOFT AND GOLDEN, FILLING THE ANCIENT GARDEN WITH THE SCENT OF WET EARTH

OBVIOUSLY I DID. OTHERWISE, YOU'D STILL BE OUT THERE ARGUING WITH THE RAIN.

YOU DIDN'T HAVE TO CARRY ME ALL THAT WAY, YOU KNOW. I COULD HAVE CRAWLED.

WHAT? WHY ARE YOU LOOKING AT ME LIKE THAT?

HER SMILE SLOWLY FADED INTO A QUIET, THOUGHTFUL GAZE, SEEING HIM THROUGH AN ENTIRELY NEW LENS.

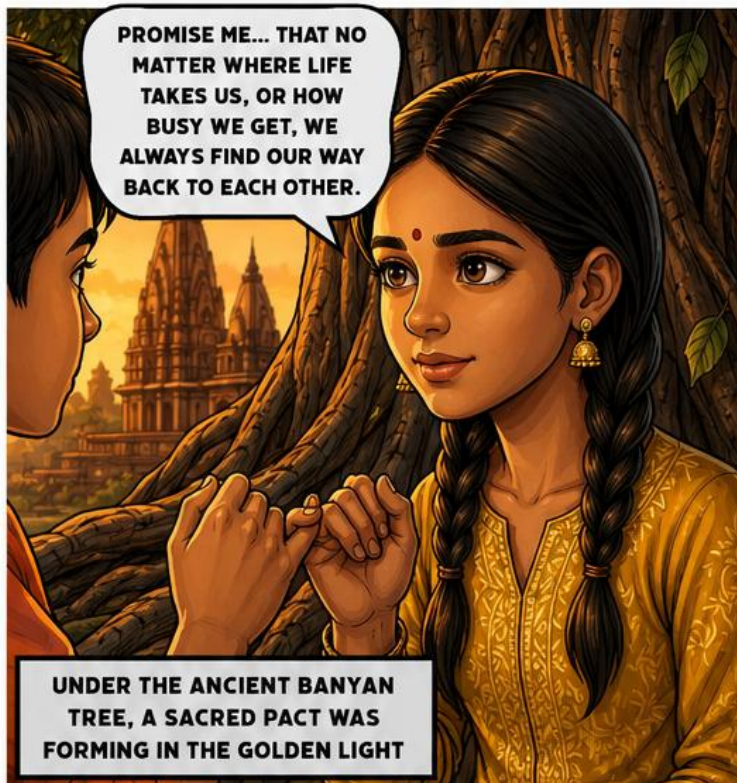
A SUDDEN WARMTH SETTLED BETWEEN THEM, HEAVY WITH WORDS LEFT UNSPOKEN

TODAY MADE ME REALIZE SOMETHING...

WHAT'S THAT?

YOU'RE NOT JUST MY FRIEND, AVNISH. YOU KNOW THAT? YOU'RE LIKE... FAMILY.

IN THE QUIET SANCTUARY OF THE BANYAN TREE, THE DEEPEST TRUTH OF THEIR BOND FINALLY LAID ITSELF BARE.



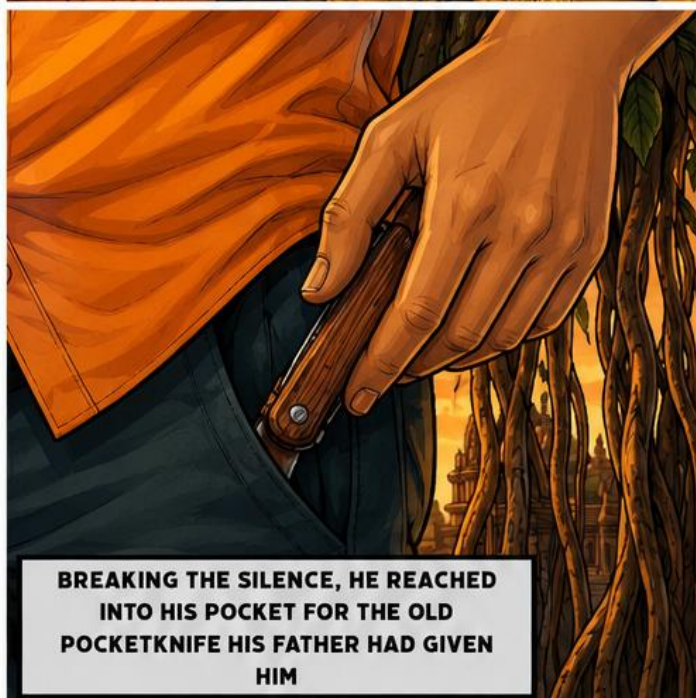
PROMISE ME... THAT NO MATTER WHERE LIFE TAKES US, OR HOW BUSY WE GET, WE ALWAYS FIND OUR WAY BACK TO EACH OTHER.

UNDER THE ANCIENT BANYAN TREE, A SACRED PACT WAS FORMING IN THE GOLDEN LIGHT

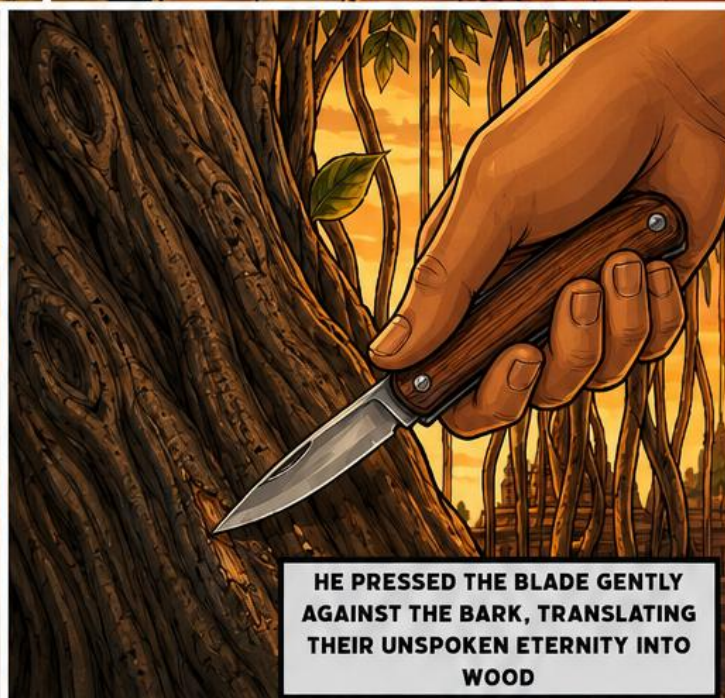


I PROMISE. EVEN WHEN YOU'RE TALKING NONSENSE ABOUT GHOSTS AND STOLEN MANGOES.

AND YOU'LL ALWAYS HAVE ME. EVEN WHEN YOU'RE BEING THE BORING MATH GUY.



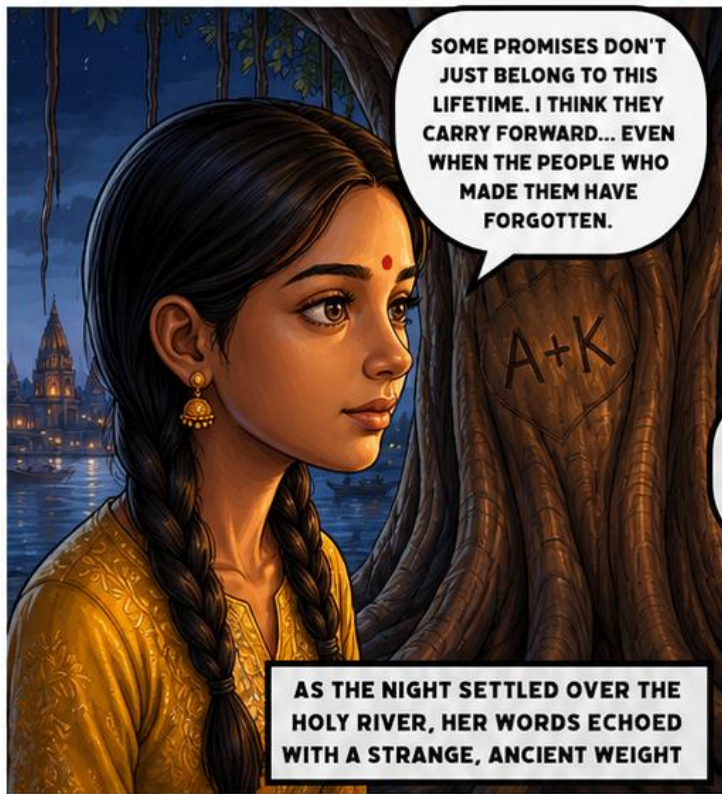
BREAKING THE SILENCE, HE REACHED INTO HIS POCKET FOR THE OLD POCKETKNIFE HIS FATHER HAD GIVEN HIM



HE PRESSED THE BLADE GENTLY AGAINST THE BARK, TRANSLATING THEIR UNSPOKEN ETERNITY INTO WOOD

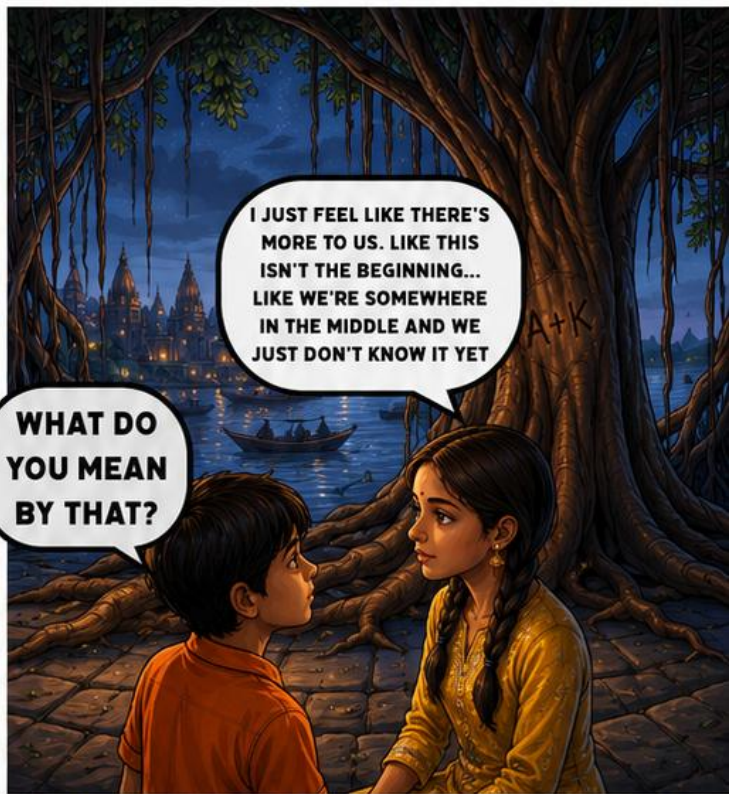


FOREVER



SOME PROMISES DON'T JUST BELONG TO THIS LIFETIME. I THINK THEY CARRY FORWARD... EVEN WHEN THE PEOPLE WHO MADE THEM HAVE FORGOTTEN.

AS THE NIGHT SETTLED OVER THE HOLY RIVER, HER WORDS ECHOED WITH A STRANGE, ANCIENT WEIGHT



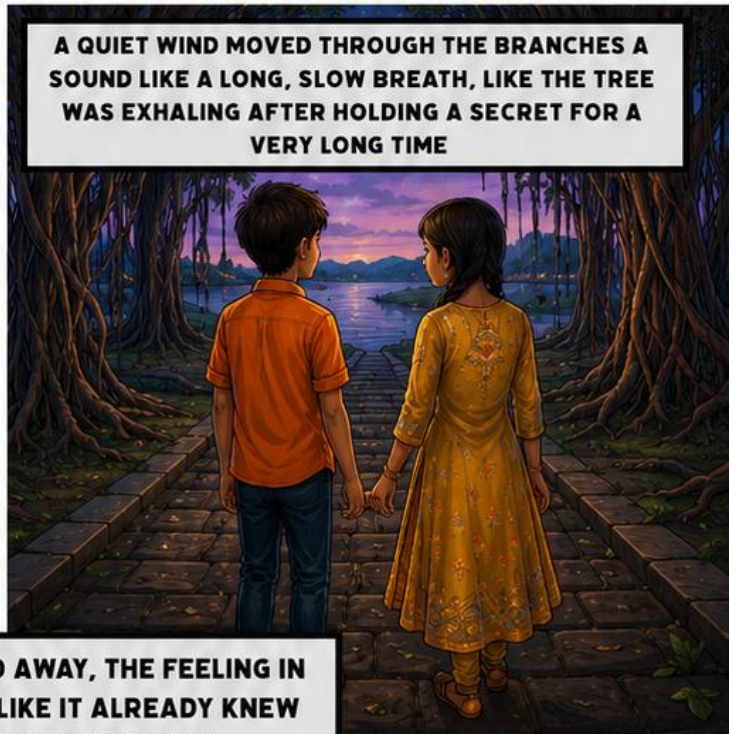
I JUST FEEL LIKE THERE'S MORE TO US. LIKE THIS ISN'T THE BEGINNING... LIKE WE'RE SOMEWHERE IN THE MIDDLE AND WE JUST DON'T KNOW IT YET

WHAT DO YOU MEAN BY THAT?



YOU'RE BEING MYSTERIOUS AGAIN, KANU.

MAYBE I AM



A QUIET WIND MOVED THROUGH THE BRANCHES A SOUND LIKE A LONG, SLOW BREATH, LIKE THE TREE WAS EXHALING AFTER HOLDING A SECRET FOR A VERY LONG TIME

BUT AS THEY WALKED AWAY, THE FEELING IN HIS CHEST STAYED... LIKE IT ALREADY KNEW HOW THIS STORY WOULD END



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KHWAAB

PART-1

अंत तो मात्र एक भ्रम है...
यह तो किसी अनंत यात्रा का आरम्भ है

राधे राधे
जय श्री कृष्ण



A LETTER FROM THE CREATOR



If you are reading this page, then it means you walked with me until the very end. Thank you. Not just for reading a graphic novel, but for giving a small dream from an ordinary person a place in your time. It still feels unreal.

Almost one and a half years ago, KHWAAAB existed only as a thought. There were no finished pages, no polished illustrations, no website, no countdowns, no audience. Just a notebook, countless ideas, and a quiet belief that one day this story deserved to exist.

Many nights I questioned myself. Many times I wanted to stop. Some pages took hours. Some pages took days. Some moments took months because I simply wasn't ready to draw them. There were days when motivation felt far away, when self-doubt was louder than hope, and when continuing felt harder than giving up. But somehow, I kept showing up for this dream, one panel at a time.

This story is completely fictional. But emotions rarely come from fiction. Many feelings hidden inside these pages were born from moments I actually lived. Moments that changed the way I looked at dreams, memories, people, hope, and letting go. Life has a strange way of leaving invisible marks on us. Sometimes people become memories. Sometimes memories become stories. And sometimes stories become the only place where those memories continue to live. Maybe that is what KHWAAAB truly became for me. Not just a graphic novel, but a place where I could quietly leave pieces of myself without ever needing to explain them.

Beyond everything, I want to share something important. Creating stories, building worlds, drawing emotions, and bringing ideas to life is not just work for me. This is my passion. I love doing this. I feel truly alive and at peace when I create. It makes me happy in ways words cannot explain. This is not something I do for fame or success. This is simply my passion, my hobby, and the place where my heart feels at home. Every page, every line, every detail comes from that love. I create because I enjoy the process. I create because it makes me feel good. And I hope that one day, this passion continues to grow and reaches even more hearts.

If even one page made you smile, if one illustration made you stop for a moment, if one scene reminded you of someone you once knew, then every sleepless night was worth it. Creating KHWAAAB taught me something I will carry forever. Dreams are rarely built in moments of confidence. Most of them are built on ordinary days when nobody is watching. When progress feels invisible. When giving up feels easier than continuing. Yet somehow, you keep creating. You keep believing. And one day, you finally reach the last page.

This is not the end of KHWAAAB. It is only the beginning. There are many more stories waiting beyond these pages. Many more worlds waiting to be discovered. Many more emotions waiting to be expressed. And I hope that when they arrive, you will still be here, walking beside me on this beautiful journey of imagination.

From the bottom of my heart, thank you for believing in this dream. Thank you for turning these pages. Thank you for supporting, sharing, waiting, encouraging, and being a part of something that means more to me than words can say. You are not just a reader. You are a part of KHWAAAB. And for that, I will always be grateful.

With gratitude,

Karthik Vijay

Creator, KHWAAAB
Anant Stories
A world by Anant VYUHA.

Some dreams
are so profound,
they reshape
reality forever.

In the world of KHWAB,
myths breathe, emotions awaken,
and imagination becomes truth.
Every page is a journey,
every frame a feeling,
every story a piece of my soul.

Thank you for being a part
of this dream.

The journey continues...



An Anant **VYUHA** Original

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